

ST PATRICK'S DONABATE

JUVENILE HANDBOOK

2026



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Introduction

The St Pats Donabate Juvenile Section is one of the fastest growing in the County. We cater for boys and girls playing football, hurling and camogie from ages 4 to 16. We have more than 50 juvenile teams currently playing our games and more than 200 children in our academy every Saturday morning.

St Pats Donabate is an integral part of the lives of our young members. Everything we do in the St Pats Donabate Juvenile section is done on a voluntary basis by our group of mentors. Some have played gaelic games for St Pats and others elsewhere; and some of whom knew nothing about Gaelic games until their children showed an interest. Everyone is welcome regardless of their background/experience in playing sport. The more people are involved the more fun it is for everyone and the lighter the load for all.

After our players, our mentors are the most important people in the Club. They train our boys and girls, arrange matches, wash jerseys, interact with referees and other officials, deal with bruises and bumps and watch young players grow through the ranks until they enter the adult section of the Club.

This handbook is a compilation of all the information mentors will need to carry out their role. This is the first iteration/version of the handbook and will undergo annual revisions based on feedback received so if you don't find the answers you are looking for, let us know. It will be considered for the next edition.

Ger Cohen

Juvenile Games Chair

June 2026

St Pats Donabate Juvenile Section Mission and Vision

The Club's Mission is to create and promote a culture that nourishes:

Participation

Accessibility for all

Teaching, nurturing and influencing the children through their participation in gaelic games

Supportive of a one Club identity

Our Children are Our Future, Show Them RESPECT

St Pats Donabate would like to stress the importance that the right attitude is present on the pitch and sidelines at all times. By all means, encourage our children but also recognise the opposition on the day are children too and deserve the respect and encouragement that we wish for our children, as do their coaches, parents, supporters, volunteers and the referees.

St Pats Donabate prides itself in providing a safe and fun family environment which lends itself to the development of all our young players and future stars.

The Club's Vision is to bring as many players as possible through from Academy to Minor level with the necessary skills to perform to the best of their ability under match conditions at a grade that is appropriate to their ability. We want our players to enjoy playing our games, be proud to be part of St Pats Donabate, to build lasting friendships through the Club and to achieve their potential in playing Gaelic games.

St Pats Donabate does not discriminate nor will we tolerate discrimination against any player, manager, coach, volunteer, parent/guardian or any other club member, or opponent on the basis of race, colour, cultural heritage, national origin, religion, age, sex, sexual orientation, marital status, physical or mental disability, political affiliation, membership of the travelling community or any other status provided for under the protection, constitution and laws of Ireland.

This policy extends to all club personnel and any other person with whom club personnel may come into contact with. St Pats Donabate will not tolerate any form of harassment, verbal or physical abuse under any circumstance, nor will we condone such actions.

Respect for the dignity of others is our guiding principle for our relations with each other and all others connected to the club, directly or indirectly. We enforce a zero-tolerance policy against all forms of discrimination, bigotry, racism, verbal or physical abuse and at all times strive to uphold the true values of sportsmanship.

SECTION 1 - JUVENILE OVERVIEW



1.1 Juvenile Committee Structure

Title	Contact	Duties
Juvenile Games Chairperson	Ger Cohen	Lead Juvenile Committee Represent Juvenile section at club executive meetings Chair Juvenile meetings Coordinate mentor ratification
Juvenile Secretary		Facilitate communication between Dublin County Board and Juvenile Coords / Mentors Team Entry into competitions Juvenile report for AGM Attend and minute meetings of Juvenile Games Committee
GPO		Coaching Strategy Mentor Support/Training School Support Academy Mini Leagues Summer Camps / Cul Camps
Academy Coordinator	Traolach O'Donnell	Boys and Girls 4yrs – 7yrs Football / LGFA Hurling / Camogie
Football Coordinator		Boys Under 8 – Minor Football
Hurling Coordinator		Boys Under 8 - Minor Hurling
LGFA Coordinator	Elaine Walsh	Girls Under 8 – Minor Football
Camogie Coordinator	Pat Martin Niamh Armstrong	Girls Under 8 –Minor Camogie
Children's' Officers	Sheila McGuinness	Children's welfare within the Club Safeguarding / Garda Vetting

Juvenile Committee 2026	Ger Cohen Alan Quinn Eimear Drea Graham Owens Lorraine Halpin Nikki Murran Philip Bourke Ray Greene Traolach O'Donnell	Build a strong juvenile section with great coaching fun and development. Create a clear pathway for players from U4 to U16. Support coaches with structure, teamwork and shared responsibility. Balance enjoyment with skill growth and healthy competitiveness. Develop confident players proud to represent St Pats.
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1.2 Club Executive 2026

Position	Name	Phone
Chairperson	Felim McAllister	086-8141908
Secretary	Jayne Elmiger-Coffey	087-2961607
Vice-Secretary	Sharon Burke	086-1503667
Treasurer	Alan Merryman	086- 816 3249
Registrar	Cormac Golden	087-7985897
Public Relations Officer	Rory O'Neill	087-7841551
Juvenile Games Chairperson	Ger Cohen	087-9879647
LGFA Secretary	Elaine Walsh	087-9047440
Children's Officer	Sheila McGuinness	086-3525113
Community Officer	Shane Dowling	086-2303811
Players' Representative	Sarah Jayne Moroney / Adam Dunne	085 197 4303/ 086-3105766
Health and Wellbeing Officer	Shane Manton	087-7702002
Cultural & Language Officer	Fiachra O'hEochaidh	086-8675100

1.3 Key Contacts 2026

Position	Name	Phone
Juvenile Games Chairperson	Ger Cohen	087-9879647
Juvenile Secretary	Jayne Elmiger-Coffey	087-2961607
2.17 C. Children's Officer	Sheila McGuinness	086-3525113
2.16 B. Designated Liaison Officer	Lorraine Ni h'Ailpin	087-6284746
GPO (Games Promotion Officer)	Traolach O'Donnel	087-4127090
Fixtures Coordinator / Pitch Allocation	Jayne Elmiger-Coffey	087-2961607
Football Referees coordinator	Dan Burke	087-4837990
Camogie Referees coordinator	Dan Burke	087-4837990
LGFA Secretary	Elaine Walsh	087-9047440
Camogie Secretary	Pat Martin	087-6229095
Football Coordinator		
Hurling Coordinator		
LGFA Coordinator		
Camogie Coordinator		
Academy Co-ordinator		
Club Registrar	Cormac Golden	087-7985897
Adult Games Chairperson	Coman Goggins / Ciaran Whelan	

1.4 Dates for Juvenile Meetings 2026

Date	Location	Time
6 th February 2026	Ballymastone	20:30
9 th April 2026	Ballymastone	20:30
11 th June 2026	Ballymastone	20:30
20 th August 2026	Ballymastone	20:30
13 th October 2026	Ballymastone	20:30
26 th November 2026	Ballymastone	20:30

1.5 Mentor ratification

Mentors are ratified annually by the Club Executive. This process is facilitated by each Lead Mentor presenting their proposed coaching team to the Juvenile Chairperson for the upcoming season, including confirmation of Garda Vetting, Safeguarding, coaching qualifications and membership status.

The Lead Mentor is responsible for ensuring effective communication within their coaching team and for supporting the implementation of club policies and initiatives. Lead Mentor contact details are listed at the end of this section.

Any mid-season updates or changes to coaching teams should be submitted to the Club Executive through the Juvenile Chairperson for review and approval. All final decisions rest with the Club Executive.

1.6 Club subscriptions/ Player Registration

Only fully paid-up members will be registered with the club. Players who have not paid their membership fees will not be permitted to train or participate in matches.

All mentors and coordinators must also be paid-up members of the club.

Membership can be completed through St Pats GAA Club website - www.stpatsgaa.com.

The annual membership deadline is 17th March. Lists of registered and paid-up members are maintained by the Club Registrar.

1.7 Club Communications

Along with the Club Website, there are 4 formal channels of communication/updates in relation to teams, results and events. Within each team, the communication with parents of players is facilitated through ClubZap.

- Website [St Pats Donabate | Home](#)
- Twitter / X [StPatsDonabate \(@StPatsDonabate\) / X](#)
- Facebook [\(20+\) Facebook](#)
- Instagram [StPats Donabate \(@stpatdonabate\)](#) • [Instagram photos and videos](#)
- ClubZap [St Pats Donabate | How to install ClubZap](#)
-

SECTION 2

THE JUVENILE

MENTOR



2.1 Role of Juvenile Mentor

St Pats Donabate is a voluntary organisation and all our activities are organised by our own members and mentors. Juvenile mentors, often parents and guardians of our young players, are the people who organise and manage training and matches.

2.2 Role of Lead Mentor

Each group will have a Lead Mentor, but the role can become too demanding if all responsibilities rest with one person. Duties such as organising training, fixtures, parent communication, match days, administration and player development should be shared across the wider coaching team. This helps make the role more manageable, sustainable and effective. Suggested role splits are outlined below and can be adapted to suit the strengths, availability and interests of each group.

All mentors, regardless of role, should:

- Coach and develop players to the best of their ability
- Encourage players to give their best for the team
- Ensure every player has a positive and enjoyable experience

Lead accountable for

- Engaging with the Dublin GAA & the club secretary regarding grading, fixtures, referees and competitions.
- Ensuring the Coach/Mentor teams are aware of the published rules for competitions for that year.
- Return of match results to County Board (mostly via automated text service) **for CC1.**
- Bi-Annual player pathway assessment, review and upkeep

2.3. Suggested Mentor roles with each group

Communications

- Send out weekly messages on training & matches
- Send out Teamer/Clubzap invites
- General information & team updates,
- Assist Club Exec Comms with Communications
- Organising an annual meeting with the Parents of the players

Safeguarding

- Keep a database of all mentors GV, SG to include expiry dates and completion of ICGG Course.
- Monitor expiry dates and new add new mentors

Referee & Match Contact

- Contact Club Ref Coordinator to arrange Refs for Home Matches
- Give feedback on referees to the Referee Coordinator
- Contact Club Facilities to confirm pitch locations for weekly matches / and agree training slots
- Contact opponents on a Monday to confirm details for matches & contact on Thurs/Friday to confirm numbers etc.
- Contact on the day for Parents / Ref money / ensure Home

Football Lead

- Establishing a Training and Development Plan for year ahead with Hurling lead
- Create Training Drills and plans for Football for 6 week block
- Demonstrate drills or give advice to other coaches on drills, plans
- Organising and managing teams on match days ensuring there is enough footballs, bibs, cones etc and that they are accessible for both training and matches.

Hurling / Camogie Lead

- Establishing a Training and Development Plan for year ahead with Football lead
- Create Training Drills and plans for Football for 6 week block
- Demonstrate drills / give advice to other coaches on drills, plans
- Organising and managing teams on match days ensuring there is enough sliothars, bibs, cones etc and that they are accessible for both training and matches.

Team Admins Group (to incl Football & Hurling Lead)

- Main Admin committee for the Year Group
- Make decisions on training / groups / match day changes
- Movement of players through panels regularly achieved & reviewed
- Make plans for the Group - trips away / blitzes

Female Liaison Officer (FLOS) if required

- A mandatory female official on team management, acting as a vital link between players, management, and the club executive, ensuring player welfare, appropriate conditions, and adherence to LGFA codes.
- Ideally remaining neutral from selection to provide impartial support and guidance for all female players.

Social Committee

- Arrange a number of social activities for the players throughout the year and the parents for team outings, bonding, social fun and for fundraising if required.
- Promoting and supporting the Club's social and fundraising activities

First Aider / CPR

- Each year to have a qualified First Aider / CPR

2.4 Suggested Team Management Structures

Role	Person 1	Person 2
Lead Mentor		
Treasurer		
Garda Vetting / Safeguarding		
Communications		
Referee & Match Contact		
Football Lead		
Camogie / Hurling Lead		
Team Admin		
Female Liaison Officer (FLOS)		
Social Committee		

2.5. Importance of season and session planning

Coaching is a 4 part process:

1. Assessment
2. Planning
3. Implementation
4. Evaluation

The Process of Planning

- Knowing Where your players are now...Taking stock
- Deciding where you want players to be...Goal setting
- Working out how to get there...Planning
- Understanding your knowledge base as a coach... Implementing
- Knowing when/if you have arrived... Monitoring and evaluation

Benefits of good planning

- Understanding-What to do.
- Confidence- The coach.
- Reduces time that the players are not active.
- Selecting appropriate activities.
- Trust from parents.
- Create goals for the player to achieve.

How To Coach Skills

- Tell – Introduce the Skill
- Explain - The Skill you are working on and demonstrate from multiple angles
- Act – Let them Play
- Coach – Spot & Fix
- Help – Provide Feedback and help them solve issues

Coaching Decision Making - Use Questioning to establish the who, what, why, how, when, where, if & then?

- Freeze and Replay
- Observe – What happened?
- Analysis – Why did it happen?
- Evaluate – Was it important?
- Plan – What are we going to do about it?

Sample session planner

St Pats Session Planner



Section 1

Date:	Attendance:	Equipment Needed:
Venue:		
Duration:		
Learning Outcomes: (2 Learning Outcomes)		
Warm-Up: Duration:	Activities & Games:	Duration: Group Management:
How To Coach Skills (for decision making): • Introduce – The Skill that you are working on • Demonstrate - The Skill you are working on from multiple angles • Explain – Explain the Activity that they will be doing • Action – Let them play • Learning – Observe and provide feedback Coaching Decision Making - Use Questioning to establish the <u>who, what, why, how, when, where, if & then?</u> • Freeze and Replay • Observe – What happened? • Analysis – Why did it happen? • Evaluate – Was it important? • Plan – What are we going to do about it? •		
Review/Evaluation (To Be Completed After the Session) • Identify 3 Positive Aspects of the Session? • Identify 3 Areas for Improvement from the Session?		

Section 2 - Training Area Layout

Section 3 - Games & Activities

Session Numbers & Durations

Based on a review of sport organisation guidelines and athlete development literature, recommendations for the optimal number of practice session per week and practice length are provided in the table. Limiting practice sessions to 90 and 120 minutes might seem counterintuitive to popular cultural depictions of what it takes to succeed in sport (e.g., we must train longer and harder than our opponents!)

AGE GROUP	COACH/PLAYER RATIO	NUMBER OF PRACTICES	PRACTICE DURATION
Under 6	1 : 4	1-2 days per week	45-60 minutes
Under 8	1 : 8	2 days per week	60-75 minutes
Under 10	1 : 8	2 days per week	60-90 minutes
Under 12	1 : 8	2-3 days per week	75-90 minutes
Under 14	1 : 10	3 days per week	75-90 minutes
Under 16	1 : 12	3-4 days per week	90-120 minutes
Under 17 years old and older	1 : 12	4-5 days per week	90-120 minutes

2.6 Coaching and Games Development

The club's Games Promotion Officer (GPO)

- Keeps mentors informed of training and coaching skills courses which are organised by the Dublin County Board throughout the year.
- Works with mentors to set realistic goals and then devise training programmes to help achieve these goals.
- Upskilling and preparing nursery coaches to prepare them for moving into Go Games.
- Runs workshops throughout the year to upskill all our coaches (a representative from each coaching group is expected to attend each workshop).
- Assists with queries in relation to the running of skills challenges for the Player Passport platform.
- Drives recruitment for the club through promoting the club and its ethos and through the coaching work carried in the various local schools.

2.7 Mentor Development

There are an increasing number of courses available for mentors to help them improve their Coaching skills. There is a series of courses run by Dublin GAA, LGFA and the Camogie Association encompassing

Course	Purpose
Introduction to Coaching Gaelic Games	Entry-level course for beginner coaches across Gaelic games; expected minimum for active coaches.
Award 1 Child	For coaches working primarily with juvenile players at child stages.
Award 1 Youth / Adult	For coaches working with older youth and adult environments where relevant.
Award 2	For experienced coaches progressing within the coach education pathway, subject to course entry requirements.
Skill-specific workshops	Short practical modules to refresh skill development, athletic development or games-based coaching.

Introduction to Gaelic Games course (ICGG)

[Introduction to Coaching Gaelic Games | Tobar](#)

The course is aimed at beginner coaches and will enable participants to assist a coach in the organisation of activities to develop Hurling, Camogie, Gaelic football and Ladies football. It is a pre-requisite, that all Club Coaches and Mentors will attend at a minimum an ICGG course. The Club Juvenile Games Chair will advise all mentors when ICGG courses are being run in the Club – typically twice a year; Sept and March. Please also refer to the Tobar website www.learning.gaa.ie for ICGG courses held in other clubs around the County.

Award 1 Coach Education Course - Youth / Adult

[Award 1 | Tobar](#)

Aimed at: Coaches of Juvenile Teams (U12 and below) with entry Requirements of ICGG course completion. Course Candidates will be 18 years or over. Candidates will be asked to abide by the GAA Code of Best Practice in Youth Sport

Award 2 Coach Education Course - Youth / Adult

[Award 2 | Tobar](#)

The Award 2 Coach Education course is the third award on the coaching pathway of Gaelic games. The course is aimed at coaches that have progressed through the Foundation Award and Award 1 programmes and have experience as a coach.

The Award 2 Coach Education course is the third award on the coaching pathway of Gaelic games. The course is aimed at coaches that have progressed through the Foundation Award and Award 1 programmes and have experience as a Coach and is aimed at: Coaches of Juvenile Teams (U12 and up).

Entry Requirements for GAA/ Hurling:

- Candidates will be over 18 years
- Hold both Foundation Award and Award 1 Child/Youth/Adult qualifications, or equivalent
- Have substantial coaching experience and are currently coaching a team at this age level
- Candidates must be Garda vetted and have completed Safeguarding 1 (Child Protection in Sport Awareness programme)
- Candidates may be required to attend for interview
- Must be nominated by club GPO or coaching officer

Entry Requirements for LGFA :

- Have completed the LGFA Level 1 Coaching Programme (GAA or Camogie Level 1 is not accepted)
- Be 18 years of age or over
- Have a minimum of five years coaching experience
- Be actively coaching in one of the following areas:
- Adult Club Football
- Underage County Player Development Programme
- Underage or Adult Inter-County Teams
- Be available to attend all four full days of the programme

Entry Requirements for Camogie

- Be 18 years of age or over
- Hold both Foundation Award and Award 1 Child/Youth/Adult qualifications
- Be an experienced coach active from U16 level and above.

Skill Specific Workshops

There are also an ongoing series of Coaching Workshops and the Club GPO will continue to provide information on these.

2.8 Additional Coaching Resources

For additional resources, see the following websites for coaching ideas etc.:

GAA

<http://www.gaa.ie>

www.dublingaa.ie

<http://learning.gaa.ie>

www.dublingaagamesdevelopment.ie

LGFA

www.lgfa.ie

www.dublinladiesgaelic.ie

CAMOGIE

www.camogie.ie

www.dublincamogie.ie

2.9 Foireann and Tobar Management

Website:

<https://www.foireann.ie/>
[Welcome to TOBAR | Tobar](#)

All mentors must have an active Foireann account. Foireann is the primary system used to manage:

- Membership records
- Garda Vetting status
- Safeguarding records
- Coach education and qualifications

Team sheets in CC2 must also be completed through Foireann, so all records and documentation must be kept fully up to date.

Viewing Your Documents

To view your records and qualifications:

1. Log in to Foireann
2. Select Manage Profile
3. Go to Qualifications

Registering on Foireann and Linking with Tobar

1. Create a Foireann account using your email address.
2. Verify your email and log in.
3. Select your club and register as a coach/mentor for the current season.
4. Complete all required details, including:
 - i. Garda Vetting
 - ii. Safeguarding
 - iii. Membership details
 - iv. Coaching role information
5. Once registered, your account should sync with Tobar, the GAA learning platform.
6. Visit the GAA learning site and choose “Log in with Foireann” using the same email address and account details.
7. Your completed courses, safeguarding certificates and coach education records should then appear in Tobar.

Troubleshooting

- If your accounts do not link correctly, ensure you are using the same email address on both systems.
- If issues remain, contact your club registrar or County Games Development Officer.

Best Practice

- Use one email address across all GAA systems to avoid duplicate accounts or missing records.
- Check your documentation regularly and do not wait until the start of the season to confirm everything is in order.

2.10 Sponsorship and Timing of Sponsorship



St Pats GAA Club, Donabate Gear Approval Form

- All Sections to be completed in full
- All match playing kit (jersey, shorts, skorts, socks) must be sourced from O'Neills - <https://www.oneills.com/shop-by-team/qaa/ireland/st-pats-donabate.html>
- All other training gear may be sourced from alternative suppliers
- Please send completed form to someone@stpats.com and someone@stpats.com for approval prior to placing order

1) Type of gear being ordered	Official O'Neill's playing kit ▼	Dropdown
2) If "Other training kit" please advise on supplier		Free text
3) Sponsor name		Free text
4) Sponsor business sector		Free text
5) Will payment be made directly by the sponsor or via the club	Direct by Sponsor ▼	Dropdown
Form Submitted By :		Free text
Team :		Free text
Date of Submission :		Free text

Kit Policy

- All kit request forms must be completed in full and approved before orders are placed.
- Official match kit, including jerseys, shorts, skorts and socks, must be sourced through the approved club supplier.
- Training gear and additional teamwear may be sourced elsewhere where appropriate, subject to club approval.
- All sponsored or branded clothing must comply with club guidelines and approved branding standards.

Sponsorship Policy

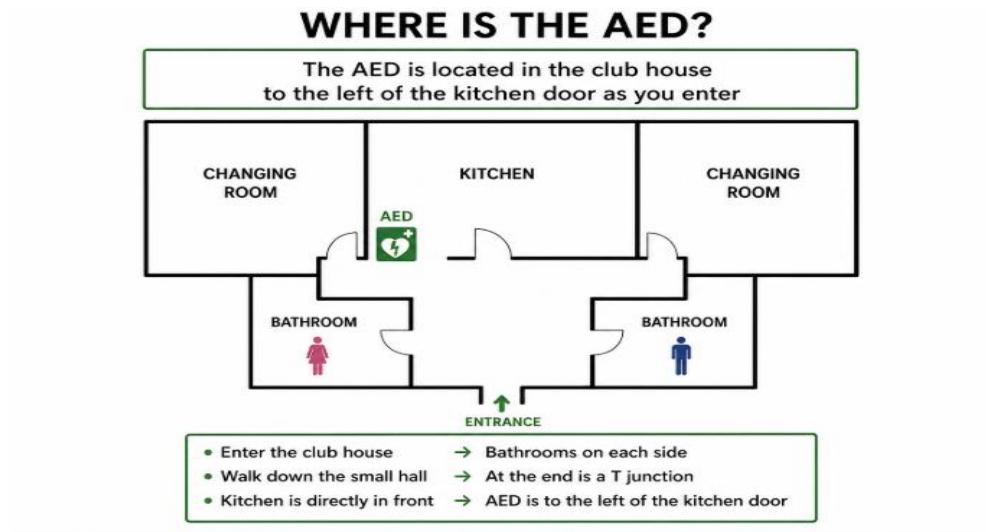
- All team sponsorship arrangements must receive prior club approval before any agreement is made.
- Lead Mentors should consider the suitability of sponsors for juvenile sport and consult with the Children's Officer or Club Executive if unsure.
- Sponsorship should support the needs of the juvenile section fairly and consistently across teams.
- No team may independently commit the club to sponsorship agreements, jersey orders or branded gear without approval.
- The club should remain mindful of sponsor fatigue within the local community and avoid overlapping fundraising or sponsorship requests.

Financial Transparency

- All fundraising and sponsorship income must be declared to the Club Treasurer and processed through approved club financial channels.
- Teams must maintain clear records of income, expenditure, receipts and supporting documentation.
- Independent or unofficial team bank accounts are not permitted.
- All sponsorship agreements, fundraising activities and financial transactions should be documented for transparency and accountability.
- On occasion Mentors may request a contribution from parents in order to subsidise sponsorship of kit / equipment or teams kitty

2.11 First Aid Training

The AED is located in the club house to the right of the kitchen door as you enter



First Aid training can be organised through Fingal

- Jamie Clowry | Sport Development Officer | Fingal Sports Office
- Fingal County Council | Civic Offices | Grove Road | Blanchardstown | Dublin 15
- Mobile: 0872846596
- Email: Jamie.Clowry@fingal.ie
- [Sports First Aid Workshops delivered by Fingal Sports Office | Fingal County Council](#)

Or directly by their first aid trainer Brian Pentony

- Email: pentonyb@gmail.com
- Phone: 087-2291838

First Aid Policy

- Each team should, wherever possible have at **least one mentor with a valid accredited First Aid qualification** in line with GAA best practice guidelines.
- First Aid certification should be renewed every two years, with responsibility on the individual mentor to ensure qualifications remain in date.
- The club will aim to provide a minimum of two First Aid training opportunities per year for coaches and mentors.
- As a long-term objective, the club will work towards having accredited First Aid cover available at a ratio of **one qualified adult per 15 players** where possible.

Club Injury policy

<https://www.stpatsgaa.com/pages/injury-procedure-physio-policy>



FIRST AID TRAINING FOR ST PATS

28.4.26 by Brian Pentony



Stay Calm
Be Prepared
Save Lives

1. AGE CATEGORIES

	Neonate	Up to 4 weeks
	Infant	4 weeks to 1 year
	Child	1 year to puberty
	Adult	12 years+

2. HEART ATTACK vs CARDIAC ARREST

HEART ATTACK (Blockage)

- Central chest pain
- Pain into arm / jaw
- Heavy sweating
- Denial
- Women: pain between shoulder blades (80% of instances)

WHAT TO DO

- Sit patient against wall
- Bend knees to chest
- Loosen tight clothing
- Give 300mg aspirin (oral)
if: over 18, no allergy, no ulcer, no bleeding disorder
- Treat as heart attack
- Call ambulance



CARDIAC ARREST (Abnormal heart pattern)

- Person unresponsive
- Not breathing normally
- Agonal gasps not normal breathing
- Clinically dead but up to 8 minutes before biologically dead

WHAT TO DO

- Start CPR immediately and use AED
- Call ambulance

3. CPR - ADULT

- Check response – shout and shake.
- Send someone for help and AED.
- Look, listen and feel for breathing for 5–10 seconds.
- Start chest compressions:
 - Hands in centre of chest
 - Lock elbows, push from shoulders
 - Push 5cm deep
 - 100–120 compressions per minute
- 30 compressions : 2 breaths (if trained and willing)



Continue until help arrives, AED takes over or patient responds.

4. CPR - CHILD & INFANT

CHILD (1 YEAR TO PUBERTY)

- Slight head tilt
- 1 or 2 hands depending on size
- Compress 3–4cm deep
- Breaths recommended

INFANT (4 WEEKS TO 1 YEAR)

- Tap foot for response
- Head neutral (do not tilt back)
- 2 fingers in centre of chest
- Cover nose and mouth with your mouth
- Puff cheeks – gentle breaths

ALL

- If unresponsive and not breathing normally, start CPR.



5. HEAD INJURIES & CONCUSSION



- Golden Rule: Bang to the head = off the pitch and stay off.
- Watch for (monitor for 24 hours):
 - Dizziness • Vomiting • Blurred vision
 - Sleepiness • Memory loss • CSF (straw-like fluid)
 - Blood from ear • Unequal pupils • Bruising around eyes

If any symptoms appear – seek medical attention.

6. NECK / SPINAL INJURIES



- Suspect if: fall from height, severe collision, clash of heads, awkward landing.
- Keep patient still
- Approach from front
- Support head in current position
- Reassure and call ambulance
- Airway first if needed – choose life

7. SPRAINS / LIGAMENT INJURIES



If they need ice, they should NOT return to play.

- R** Rest – stay off injured limb
- I** Ice – 10–15 mins initially, then 10 mins every hour
- C** Compression – bandage
- E** Elevation – above heart

Seek medical help if swelling doesn't reduce in 24–36hrs or pain persists.

8. BLEEDING & WOUNDS



HEAD WOUNDS

- Pad over injury
- Apply pressure 6–7 minutes
- Bandage firmly

OTHER WOUNDS / SERIOUS BLEEDS

- Elevate limb
- Apply pad & pressure
- Add more pads if needed
- Bandage firmly
- Keep limb elevated

EMBEDDED OBJECT: Do not remove. Pad either side and seek medical help.

9. FRACTURES / BREAKS



- Keep still and support above and below injury
- Keep warm
- Seek medical attention

Arm: support in comfortable position.
Shoulder: support elbow with pillow / blanket.
Finger: buddy tape to next finger.

10. NOSEBLEEDS



- Sit down
- Lean forward
- Pinch soft part of nose
- Hold 10 mins
- Repeat once if needed
- Do not lean back

Seek medical help if bleeding continues beyond 20 minutes.

11. ASTHMA



Triggers:

- High pollen count
- Cold / damp weather
- Exhaustion
- Anxiety

If asthma attack:

- Sit upright, leaning forward
 - Use reliever inhaler
 - Open doors/windows if indoors
 - Call ambulance if severe or not improving
- * Should a child with an inhaler at a match or training be allowed to play? *

12. SEPSIS

Can come on fast from infection.

Watch for:

- Unable to pass urine
 - Shivering / vomiting / diarrhoea
 - Rash that doesn't fade
 - Change in mental status
 - High temp ($>38^{\circ}\text{C}$) or low ($<36^{\circ}\text{C}$)
- Young and elderly more at risk. Seek urgent medical help.

13. WEIL'S DISEASE



- Can look like sepsis. From rat urine in rivers, bushes entering cuts.
- Wash hands
- Cover cuts
- Seek medical help if concerned

14. CHOKING



ADULT / TEEN

- 5 back blows
- 5 abdominal thrusts
- Continue alternating
- If unresponsive – CPR

CHILD

- Same as adult (kneel behind)
- Adjust hand size

INFANT

- 5 back blows
- 5 chest thrusts
- If unresponsive – CPR

18. APPENDICITIS



Look for:

- Lower right abdominal pain
 - Vomiting
 - High or low temperature
 - No bowel movement
 - Abdominal swelling
 - Pain when lifting leg
- Seek medical attention.

16. STROKE - FAST

- F** Face – is their face even?
- A** Arm – can they hold both arms up?
- S** Speech – is their speech slurred?
- T** Time – call ambulance immediately.

Also check:

- Tongue – does it move to one side?
- Finger to nose test
- Hand grip strength

If unconscious – start CPR.
If conscious – place in recovery position.

17. RECOVERY POSITION



- Roll onto side
- Head tilted back slightly
- Mouth angled downward
- Top knee bent
- Monitor breathing continuously



- ✓ 300mg Aspirin
- ✓ Biofreeze Gel
- ✓ Instant Ice Packs
- ✓ Foil Blankets

- ✓ Sterile Pads / Dressings
- ✓ Bandages (various sizes)
- ✓ Tape
- ✓ Disposable Gloves

- ✓ Scissors
- ✓ Hand Sanitiser
- ✓ CPR Face Shield
- ✓ Notebook & Pen



IF IN DOUBT, SIT THEM OUT AND GET IT CHECKED OUT.
Better a few minutes missed than months lost.



Emergency Priorities

- Make area safe before approaching.
- Check response and breathing.
- Send for help. Call 112 / 999.
- Treat the most serious issue first.
- Reassure casualty and monitor.

Heart Attack vs Cardiac Arrest

- Heart attack: chest pain, pain to arm/jaw/back, sweating, nausea.
- Sit supported, loosen clothing, call emergency services.
- 300mg aspirin only if appropriate and no contraindications.
- Cardiac arrest: unresponsive and not breathing normally. Start CPR.

CPR Quick Guide

- 30 compressions then 2 breaths if trained.
- Hands centre chest, lock elbows, push hard and fast.
- Adult depth approx 5cm at 100 to 120 compressions per minute.
- Continue until help arrives or AED available.

Head Injuries / Concussion

- Bang to head = off pitch and stay off.
- Watch for vomiting, dizziness, confusion, sleepiness, memory loss.
- Monitor for 24 hours and seek medical review.

[GAA Concussion Guide](#)

[GAA Concussion Ref for Clubs A3 Poster PRINT.indd](#)

Sprains / Rolled Ankles

- RICE = Rest, Ice, Compression, Elevation.
- If they need ice, they should not return to play that day.

Asthma / Choking / Stroke

- Asthma: sit upright, assist inhaler, call help if severe.
- Choking: 5 back blows then thrusts. If unresponsive start CPR.
- Stroke: FAST = Face, Arm, Speech, Time.

Pitchside First Aid Kit

- Gloves, CPR shield, ice packs, dressings, gauze, bandages, tape.
- Foil blanket, scissors, hand sanitiser, notebook, phone.

Golden Rule

- If in doubt, sit them out and get it checked out.

2.12 Player Injury Schemes & Injury Reporting

The player injury schemes across the GAA, LGFA and Camogie Association are support schemes and not full insurance policies. Parents and guardians should understand that these schemes are designed to supplement private health insurance and do not automatically cover all medical expenses. Where players have private medical insurance (such as VHI, Laya or Aviva), claims should first be submitted through those providers before any application is made through the relevant Gaelic Games injury scheme.

All injuries which may require treatment should be reported promptly through the appropriate code process and also communicated to the club. Mentors should ensure that any significant match injury is brought to the referee's attention for inclusion in the official match report where applicable.

St Pats Donabate is not in a position to cover medical or treatment expenses outside the terms of the relevant injury schemes.

The club Injury Fund contact is Sharon Burke. Injuries should be registered as soon as possible by emailing: injuryfund.stpatricksdonabate.dublin@gaa.ie

For LGFA injuries, the initial claim form must be submitted within 8 weeks of the injury occurring or the claim may not be covered under the scheme.

Useful Links:

- [GAA Injury Benefit Fund](#)
- [LGFA Injury Fund Information](#)
- [St Pats Injury Procedure & Physio Policy](#)

2.13 Annual Parents Meeting

All mentor groups are strongly recommended to hold an annual parents meeting at the beginning of each season. These meetings are an important opportunity to outline expectations, communicate plans for the year ahead and strengthen engagement between mentors, parents and players.

Parent Meeting Requirements

- A parent meeting is strongly recommended for all teams each season.
- Meetings should take place annually during January or February, with all meetings completed by the end of February where possible.
- The Boot Room should be made available as the preferred meeting location where feasible.
- Mentors are encouraged to circulate an agenda in advance and communicate meeting minutes or key actions afterwards as best practice.
- Teams may also find it beneficial to hold shorter recap or update meetings during the season, particularly in June or September.

Purpose of the Meeting - Parent meetings should aim to:

- Outline the structure and format of the season ahead
- Set clear expectations for players, parents and mentors
- Encourage positive sideline behaviour and club culture
- Improve communication and parent engagement
- Support player welfare and development
- Encourage volunteer involvement across the team and club

Suggested Agenda for Parent Meetings - The following items are recommended as part of the annual parent meeting agenda:

Season Overview

- Format of the season ahead
- Fixture schedule and training plans
- Team structures for the season or relevant playing block
- Coaching philosophy, goals and player development focus

Attendance & Communication

- Importance of attendance at training sessions and matches
- Importance of timely responses to ClubZap or mentor communications
- Team communication expectations and use of approved club communication channels

Club Policies & Expectations

- Club Code of Behaviour
- Sideline behaviour expectations for parents and supporters
- Social media expectations and guidance
- Reminder regarding payment of club membership fees following AGM

Player Welfare

- Discussion around any relevant medical, physical, emotional or behavioural needs of players and how best to support them
- Dietary considerations where relevant
- Overview of safeguarding and player welfare supports

Team Development & Grading - Depending on the age group, mentors may also need to explain:

- Team grading or streaming structures
- How grading decisions are made
- How team structures may change throughout the season
- Match formats and progression through age grades

Team Activities & Club Support

- Team fundraising or sponsorship plans
- Away trips or social activities
- Supporting wider St Pats Donabate fundraising initiatives
- Encouraging support for adult and senior club teams

Parent Involvement & Volunteer Support - Mentors are encouraged to identify opportunities for parents to become involved in supporting the team and club, including:

- Pitch set up and equipment support
- Match day organisation and logistics
- FLO and welfare support roles
- Team administration and communication support
- Social event organisation
- Sponsorship and fundraising support
- Recording introductory match statistics or assisting with technology/tools

Mentor Administration - Lead Mentors must provide the Club Registrar and/or Executive with a full list of proposed mentors for the season, including:

- Name
- Phone number
- Email address
- Proposed role within the group structure

Best Practice Guidance - Mentor groups are encouraged to develop and communicate a clear team mission, vision and coaching philosophy appropriate to their age group. Best practice examples may include:

- A focus on enjoyment, inclusivity and participation
- Long-term player retention and development
- Age-appropriate skill progression
- Clear communication around training standards and expectations
- Transparent communication around grading and team structures as players progress through the juvenile pathway.

Team Parent Meeting Template - generic

Team Mission

To create a fun, safe and inclusive team environment where every player can develop their skills, build friendships and enjoy Gaelic Games.

We aim to place an emphasis on:

- *Player development*
 - *Teamwork and honesty of effort*
 - *Respect for team mates, coaches, referees and opponents*
 - *Participation and enjoyment over results*
-

Team Vision

“As many as possible, for as long as possible.”

Our goal is to create an environment where players can continue to learn, develop and progress through the juvenile pathway while enjoying their experience within the club.

Season Focus

Coaching & Player Development

- *Focus on the development of core skills in both training and match scenarios*
- *Encourage players to improve skills at speed and under pressure*
- *Build confidence, teamwork and game awareness*
- *Use game-based activities and age-appropriate coaching*
- *Promote effort, resilience and enjoyment*

Training Standards

- *Training sessions will start on time*
 - *Players should arrive prepared and ready to train*
 - *Coaches will aim to create a positive, energetic and structured environment*
 - *Parents are encouraged to support regular attendance and practice outside of club training where possible*
-

Matches & Team Structure

- *Teams and panels may be reviewed during the season depending on player numbers, attendance and development needs*
- *Coaches will aim to maximise participation and player development across all teams*

- *As players progress through age groups, match formats, grading structures and logistics may change*
 - *Parent support may be required throughout the season for:*
 - *Transport and lifts*
 - *Pitch set up*
 - *Match day organisation*
 - *FLO and volunteer support*
-

Communication & Expectations

- *Team communication will take place through the approved club communication channels*
 - *Respectful behaviour is expected from players, coaches and parents at all times*
 - *Coaches are volunteers and will always act in the best interests of the players and team*
 - *Positive sideline behaviour is encouraged to help create the best environment for all players*
-

Parent Questions & Discussion

This section can be used during the meeting for questions, feedback and discussion points relevant to the team and upcoming season.

2.14 Sample Annual Calendar and Key Dates

Month	Typical focus
January	Registration push, mentor ratification, planning meetings, county rules review Commencement of u14 football/Hurling player selection for county Talent ID and start of the process engaging with Dublin GAA Development team.
February	Season start, parent meetings, training structure set Player pathway challenges Boys Feile panels will be requested by Dublin GAA. Conditions will be provided in the request.
March	Membership deadline, early fixtures, coach support workshops
April	Panel review, holiday planning, first committee checkpoint, Easter camp. Boys Football and Hurling Feile will run in early & late April, depending on Dublin GAA timelines.
May-June	League progression, challenge games, player development review, MAI hurling / camogie Meeting with u12/u13 re grading plan for following season Féile usually takes place May - June County u14 Talent selection process for GAA Hurling/Football concludes.
July-August	Summer camps, adjusted schedule, second panel review, MAI football. Most underage teams usually take a break during this period.
September-October	Championship windows, school-year reset, parent communication refresh Player pathway challenges Consider football player nominations for GAA county selection for the following year (at u14s).
November	Committee review, end-of-season reflection, planning for next year. Next year's Feile table quiz funding event for Boy's Feile team.
December	Membership prep, awards / social, handbook review updates.

2.15 Code of Best Practice

The Club code of Ethics & Guidelines for the Protection of Children is available in the [downloads](#) section of the Club's website – www.stpatsgaa.com/pages/child-protection

Also available on www.stpatsgaa.com/pages/child-protection is [Our Games - Our Code, the joint Code of Best Practice in Youth Sport](#). This Code has been agreed between the GAA, the Ladies Gaelic Football Association, the Camogie Association, GAA Handball Ireland and the Rounders Council of Ireland. The Code replaces all previous Codes and is a mandatory Code of Best Practice for all Gaelic Games Associations in our work with underage players.

The [GAA Code of Behaviour](#) complements the [Irish Sports Council \(ISC\) Code of Ethics](#) and [Our Games - Our Code, the joint Code of Best Practice in Youth Sport](#) and addresses the appropriate levels of behaviour, practice and conduct required from our young players, officials, coaches, trainers, mentors, supporters, parents/guardians and clubs.

The [GAA Code of Behaviour](#) is jointly promoted by the GAA, the Camogie Association), Ladies Gaelic Football Association, Irish Handball Council and Rounders Council of Ireland.

Relevant documents are available on www.dublinladiesgaelic.ie and www.dublincamogie.ie

2.16 Child Protection

Each year the Lead Mentor must supply the Club Registrar/Exec with a full list of their proposed Mentors, including phone and email contact details.

Each year the St Pats Donabate Club Executive ratifies the mentors who will be involved in working with our juvenile teams. This includes ensuring mentors have:

1. Undergone the GAA's Garda Vetting process and have a valid cert on Foireann
2. Hold an in date valid Safeguarding confirmation
3. Are paid up members of the Club
4. Have completed the Introduction to Gaelic Games Course
5. First aid training (1 per 15 players) (PHECC approved)

2.16 A. Garda Vetting in St Pats Donabate

[St Pats Donabate | GARDA VETTING - NB](#)

We are informed that the National Vetting Bureau (Children and Vulnerable Persons) Acts requires that all GAA personnel who work with children and vulnerable adults shall be required to be vetted. This is a legal requirement

It is worth noting that should any person who **has not been vetted**, and who has not previously worked with children in the GAA, and who subsequently seeks on our behalf to work with children and or vulnerable adults, they will be in breach of the law. Should we employ or recruit a person to do this work who has not been vetted the Club will also be breaching the law.

Who within the GAA needs to be Garda Vetted in accordance with the Act?

- Coaches: In the context of the GAA those members, i.e. coaches, trainers, mentors, parents and others who provide services to children and vulnerable adults, on behalf of the Association, and who are in direct contact with children or vulnerable persons in the GAA shall be vetted. It should be noted that it will be illegal for an individual to put themselves forward to work with children or vulnerable adults before successfully completing the Garda Vetting Bureau process.
- Committee members: As a policy of best practice, it is strongly recommended that Officers of Committees that oversee underage and juvenile activities at Club and County level should also be vetted.
- Referees: Referees of underage games must also be vetted.

Are there any exemptions from vetting for occasional or temporary roles?

While the preference of the GAA is to vet all persons who work in a role of responsibility with children and underage players there is a recognition that occasionally a guest coach may be invited to work in a supervised role with children. At the discretion of the local Club or unit it shall be permissible for a person acting in an occasional or temporary role, who has not previously been vetted by the GAA, to fulfil this role as per the following conditions:

- The person must be known to the local Club or unit
- A non-vetted individual may only carry out a 'temporary' role for a maximum of three occasions per year
- All such persons must be over 18 yrs of age
- They must, in advance of commencing their role, complete and submit a vetting application form (e.g. AccessNI/ Garda Vetting)
- They must sign a copy of the Code of Behaviour (Underage)
- They must at all times be under the supervision of a vetted volunteer/staff person

2.16 B Safeguarding

St Pats Donabate | Child Safeguarding - Cosaint Leanaí

SAFEGUARDING:

'Face-to-face Child Safeguarding 1 workshops take place in the club throughout the year. This certification is valid for a 3-year period and can be extended for a further 3 years by completing the online refresher course within 6 weeks of expiry renewal date'. To be certified for the Safeguarding course you will first need to register with Tobar (<https://learning.gaa.ie/user/register>), the online Gaelic Games Learning Portal. You will be sent a link to enrol on the course via this platform. This is essential to receive your certificate. The course itself takes approximately 3 hours. Please contact childrensofficer.stpatricksdonabate.dublin@gaa.ie for information on future courses.

2.16 C. Designated Liaison Officer

The Club is obliged to have a Designated Liaison Officer who is responsible for reporting allegations of abuse to the statutory authorities. Any disclosures of abuse or potential abuse must be reported to the Designated Liaison Officer. The Clubs DLO is Lorraine Ni h'Ailpin

Designated Liaison Officer: Lorraine Halpin - chairperson.stpatricksdonabate.dublin@gaa.ie

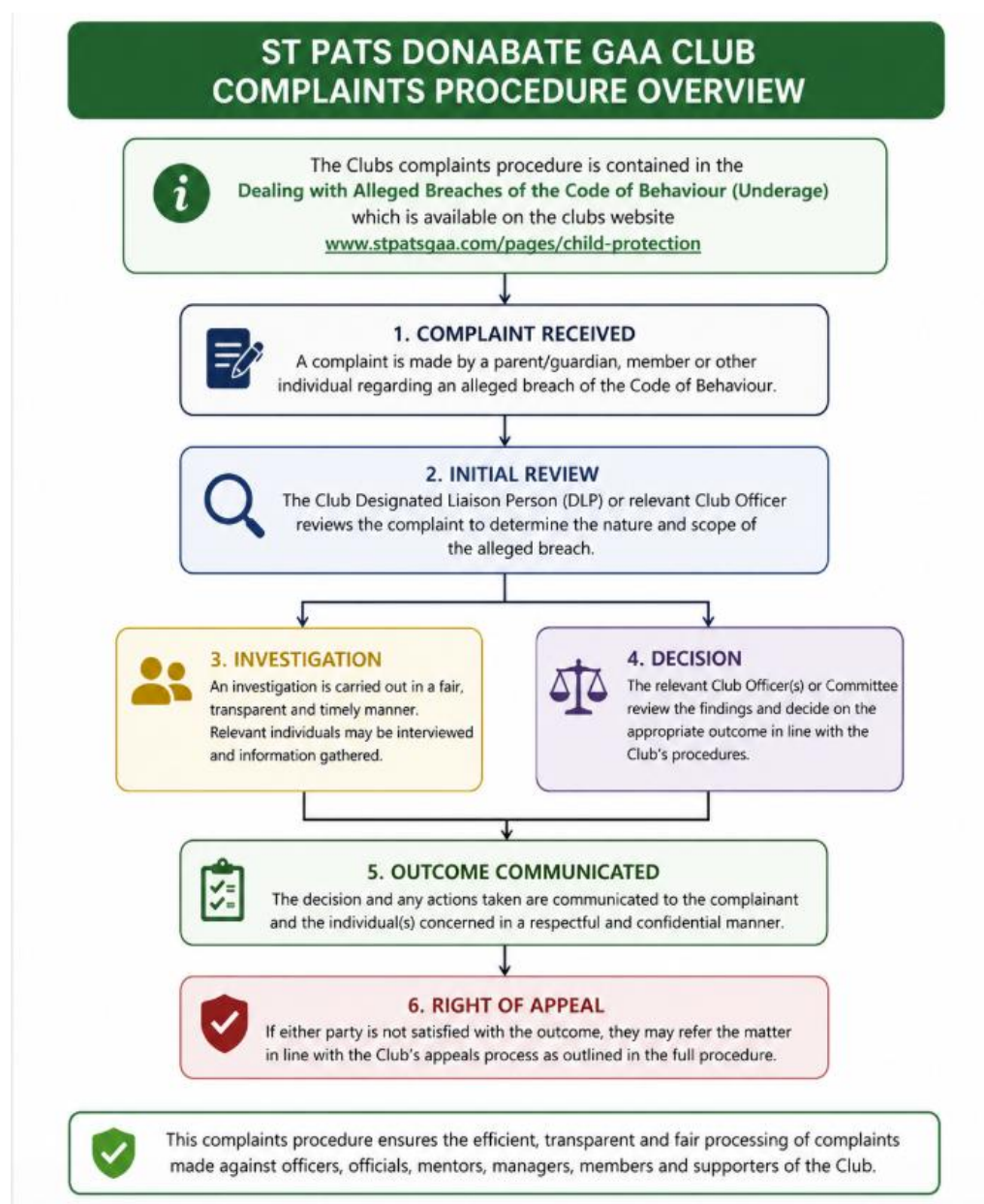
2.16 D. Children's Officer

The Club also has a Children's Officer. Any issues regarding child welfare may be referred to them. The Clubs CPO is Sheila McGuinness

Children's Officer: Sheila McGuinness - childrensofficer.stpatricksdonabate.dublin@gaa.ie

2.17 Complaints Procedure

The Clubs complaints procedure is contained in the Dealing with Alleged Breaches of the Code of Behaviour (Underage) which is available on the clubs website www.stpatsgaa.com/pages/child-protection. The complaints procedure ensures the efficient, transparent and fair processing of complaints made against officers, officials, mentors, managers, members and supporters of the Club.



2.18 Communications & Social Media

GAA Policy - [Contacting Underage Players](#)

The club is committed to ensuring that all communication with underage players is safe, transparent, appropriate and in line with GAA safeguarding guidance.

Core Principles

- Communication regarding training, matches, fixtures or club activities should be directed through parents/guardians wherever possible.
- One-to-one private messaging between mentors/coaches and underage players is not permitted.
- All communication should take place through approved club communication channels and in group settings with appropriate adult oversight.
- Communication should always remain professional, respectful and directly related to club activities.

Approved Communication Channels

Mentors and coaches should use approved club systems such as:

- ClubZap
- Foireann
- Official club email groups

Where possible:

- Group chats should have at least two adult admins
- Communication should remain visible and transparent
- Records of communication should be retained where practical

Communication with Parents & Guardians

- All group texts, emails and updates should normally be sent to parents/guardians.
- If a parent/guardian requests that communication be sent directly to a player, this request must be made in writing.
- Any direct communication must still be through group messaging only and not through private one-to-one contact.
- Mentors should retain a copy of any written parental request.

Coaches & Mentors Should

- Use group communication channels only
- Keep communication focused on logistics, fixtures, training and club matters
- Maintain a professional tone at all times
- Avoid sending late-night messages where possible
- Ensure communication remains open and visible to parents and club oversight

Coaches & Mentors Should Never

- Send private direct messages to an underage player
- Use disappearing message platforms or apps
- Engage in one-to-one social conversations with minors
- Share personal photos, videos or unrelated content
- Ask a child to keep communication private
- Arrange lifts or meetings through private messaging

Direct Contact from Players

If an underage player obtains a mentor's phone number or email address and attempts to make direct contact:

- The mentor should advise the player not to contact them privately
- The parent/guardian should be informed
- Guidance should be sought from the Juvenile Committee or Children's Officer if required

2.19 Social Media Posting Guidelines

GAA Policy can be found here:

<https://www.gaa.ie/api/pdfs/image/upload/skixfguu6n6lj6kx7fl2.pdf>

Social Media & Image Sharing Policy

The club recognises the positive role social media plays in promoting our games, teams, community and achievements. All online activity connected to the club should reflect the values of respect, inclusiveness, child welfare and community spirit.

Permissions & Consent

- At the beginning of each season, Lead Mentors should request parent/guardian permission through ClubZap for the sharing of photographs and videos.
- Parent/guardian consent must be in place before any child's image is shared publicly on social media.
- Consent records should be retained by the team or relevant club officer.

Sharing Images & Videos

- Images and videos may be shared within official ClubZap team groups where appropriate.
- Any wider sharing on public social media platforms (Facebook, Instagram, X, website etc.) must:
 - have confirmed parent/guardian permission
 - be approved through the club's appointed social media person/PRO
 - reflect the values and standards of the club

Guidelines for Online Content

- Content should be positive, respectful and suitable for a family audience.
- Images should focus on the activity, team or event rather than an individual child where possible.
- Children should be appropriately dressed in all images and videos.
- No personal details, contact information or sensitive information relating to children should ever be shared online.
- Team photos are permitted, but players should not be individually identified unless permission has been granted.
- No criticism of players, coaches, referees, parents, volunteers or opponents should be posted online.
- Social media must never be used for bullying, abusive comments, trolling or inappropriate behaviour.
- Only approved club administrators may post on official club or team social media accounts.

General

- Once content is posted online it may be shared publicly and remain accessible permanently. Always think before posting.
- The club reserves the right to request the removal of any content considered inappropriate or not in line with club values or GAA guidelines.
- This policy is guided by the GAA Social Media Guidelines and Code of Best Practice for Youth Sport.

2.20 Current Points of Contact for Juvenile Teams

Juvenile hurling 2026

<https://d1cnc2w242mbew.cloudfront.net/f/311724/x/819a5e1587/juvenile-2026-hurling-contacts-v7.xlsx>

Juvenile football 2026

<https://d1cnc2w242mbew.cloudfront.net/f/311724/x/7da42e9fac/juvenile-2026-football-contacts-v6.xlsx>

Juvenile LGFA / Camoige 2026

<lgfa-club-mentor-contact-list-as-per-17th-march-2026.pdf>

<u>Year Group</u>	<u>Boys / Girls</u>	<u>Name</u>
Minor	Boys	Ronan Fitzpatrick
Minor	Girls	Kevin Maher
2010	Boys	Coman Goggins
2011	Boys	Phil Bourke / Rita Wall
2011	Girls	Liam Hegarty / Liz Fletcher
2012	Boys	Fiachra O Mathuna
2012	Girls	Michael Murphy
2013	Boys	Conor Davey
2013	Girls	Niamh Armstrong
2014	Boys	Guillaume Rhein
2014	Girls	Ger Cohen
2015	Boys	Neil McDonagh
2015	Girls	Denise Gallagher
2016	Boys	Daniel Montgomery
2016	Girls	Emma Tobin
2017	Boys	Stephen Cunningham
2017	Girls	Eimear Drea
2018	Boys	John Hanley
2018	Girls	Hugh Feeney
2019	Boys	Ray Greene
2019	Girls	Nikki Murran
Academy	Both	Traolach O'Donnell

SECTION 3

PLAYER DEVELOPMENT



3.1. Nursery Overview

Player development starts with our nursery

St Pats Nursery Programme – Mentor Summary

Our Purpose

The St Pats Nursery Programme introduces children aged 4–6 to Gaelic Games in a **fun, safe and engaging environment** that builds confidence, movement skills, enjoyment of sport, and a lifelong connection with St Pats.

Our guiding principle is simple - **Children play sport because it is fun.** Everything we do should reflect that.

Our Coaching Philosophy

The Nursery focuses on developing **Physical Literacy** — helping children learn how to move confidently and competently so that they can enjoy a lifelong involvement in Sports.

This means building:

- **Physical Competence** – movement skills and sporting skills
- **Confidence & Motivation** – helping children feel capable and enjoy participation
- **Knowledge & Understanding** – creating positive habits around activity and sport

The objective is: “As many as we can, for as long as we can.”

What We Coach

The Nursery sits within the **GAA Foundation 1 (F1) Player Pathway**, with an emphasis on fundamental movement and early game skills.



Core Skill Areas



The aim is to create children who are:

- confident movers
- enthusiastic participants

Understanding 4–6 Year Olds

Children in this age group:

- have short attention spans
- are still learning cooperation
- often focus only on the ball
- respond best to games, races and fun challenges
- learn through demonstration, repetition and encouragement

Coaching should therefore be:

- active
- simple
- energetic

- positive
- Game-based

The St Pats Coaching Approach

All nursery mentors should follow our coaching model:



Mentor Expectations - All mentors are expected to:

- Complete **Garda Vetting**
- Complete **GAA Child Safeguarding**
- Support a safe, inclusive environment
- Follow the coaching plan
- Help with set-up and clean-up
- Encourage effort, fun and participation for every child

Nursery Rules We Reinforce - Children should learn to:

- Be on time
- Respect equipment
- Give their best effort
- Be kind to others
- Encourage teammates
- Play fairly
- Have fun

Final Reminder - At nursery level, **we are not coaching winning teams — we are developing happy, confident children who love Gaelic Games. Fun first. Movement & Skills second, Development always.**

3.2 Player Passport Instructions

The St Pats Donabate Player pathway model maps out the incremental development of players starting from 4 yrs. of age up to minor. It maps out the player characteristics, skill competence and physical attributes of players as they grow and develop - all of these are linked back to the Dublin GAA player pathway model.

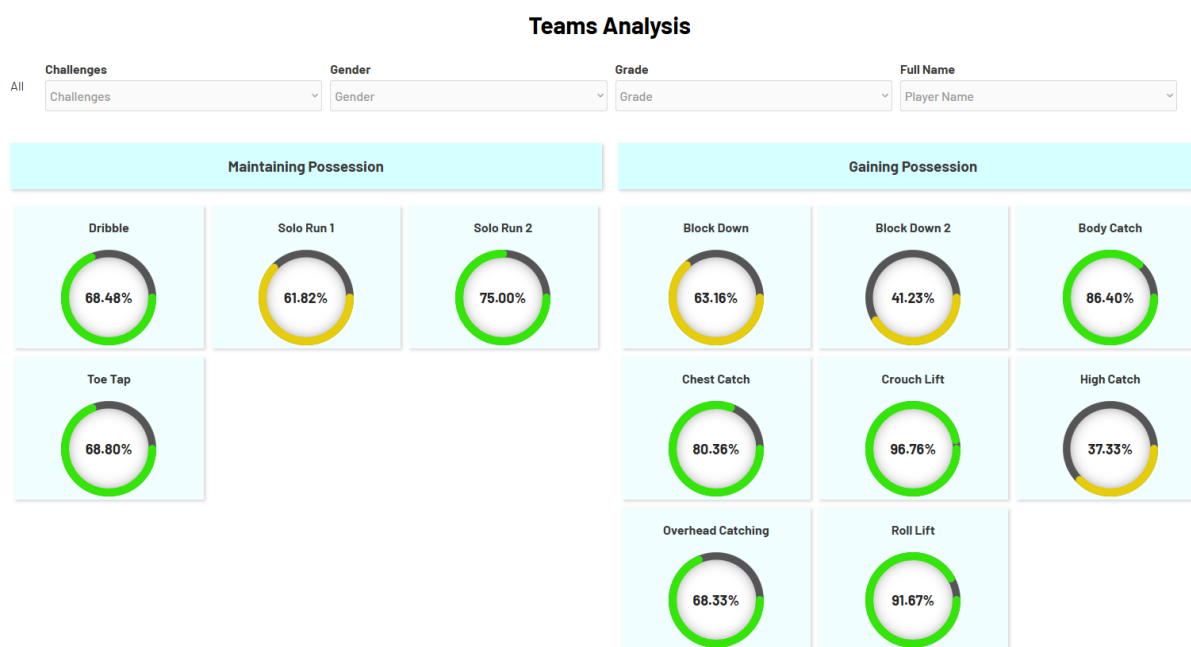
The club collates of all this information in one single database, see below :

[Player Passport | Youth Athletic Development App](#)

Skills challenges are to be completed twice annually, and are broken into the following categories :

- Hurling / camogie skills challenges
- Football / ladies football skills challenges
- Functional movement challenges

When these challenges are completed the above mentioned database produces a dashboard of results. Based on these, gaps can be identified and training tailored accordingly to address these gaps :



The skills challenges should be completed for all teams within the juvenile section as outlined above.

3.3 Suggested Skill List by Age Group

		ST PATS DONABATE SKILLS CHART					
DEVELOPING PLAYERS • BUILDING CONFIDENCE • PLAYING TOGETHER • ACHIEVING SUCCESS							
HURLING SKILLS							
7-9 YEARS OLD LEARNING TO USE THE BALL WELL		10-12 YEARS OLD LEARNING TO PLAY TOGETHER		13-15 YEARS OLD LEARNING ABOUT POSITIONS			
• Handling - Claw catch - Cupped catch • Sending & Receiving - Ground striking (a moving ball) left & right - Ground doubling (same direction/opposite direction) - Striking from the hand (stationary) - Jab lift (stationary ball) • Travelling - Bean bag balancing - Ball balancing • Tackling - Ground flick (backhand) - Ground clash - Hooking - Frontal & ground block (Hurl to hurl)		• Handling - Overhead catch (hurl to protect) - Hand passing (using both hands) • Sending & Receiving - Striking on the run - Short stick left & right - Striking off hurl - First touch control - Jab lift (moving ball) - Roll lift (moving ball) - Lift & strike - Batting high ball - Sideline cuts • Travelling - Soloing at speed • Tackle - Shouldering - Hooking on the move - Blocking (ground & air) - Doubling in the air		• Handling - High catch (protect from front & behind) - Hand pass off the hurley - Chest catch • Sending & Receiving - Jab lift at pace - Striking on the run (moving away from the target) - Striking on the run (high & low) - Doubling ball in the air - Shooting for scores • Travelling - Soloing (changing direction) - Tap & move • Tackle - Frontal block (hurl to ball) - Low block - Ground tussle - Flick off the hurley (snig)		• Handling - Ball Winning - Catching (protect from front & behind) - High catch - Low catch - Half volley catch - First touch off the hurl, low-high control - Dribble - keep possession • Sending & Receiving - Lift & strike, left & right - Strike, front foot & back foot - Feint & strike - Striking over the shoulder moving away from the target - Overhead doubling - Batting - Overhead kill (ball falls into your body) - Overhead block to the feet - Over head flick (direct the ball in your path) • Travelling - Making room (with & without the ball) - Take opponent & protecting the body with the hurl. - Dummy hand pass. • Tackle - Shouldering, recover and flick & hook.	
FOOTBALL SKILLS							
7-9 YEARS OLD LEARNING TO USE THE BALL WELL		10-12 YEARS OLD LEARNING TO PLAY TOGETHER		13-15 YEARS OLD LEARNING ABOUT POSITIONS			
• Handling - Body catch - Low catch - High catch - Fist pass - Hand pass - Crouch lift (stationary ball) • Kicking - Punt kick (hard foot) left & right - Hook kick (one hand) - Pick up-foot • Travelling - High bounce - Toe tap (stationary) - Soft foot - Roll • Tackling - Near hand tackle - Shadowing - Frontal tackle - Block down		• Handling - High catch (protect from front & behind) - Hand pass (using both hands) • Kicking - Punt kick left & right - Punt kick outside foot - Crouch lift moving ball - Toe lift - Hook kick left & right • Travelling - Soloing (changing direction) - Tap & move • Tackle - Frontal block - Low block - Ground tussle - Flick off		• Handling - Ball feint - Fist pass for distance - Overhead tap on - Catching at speed - High catch - Reach catch - Low catch - Half volley catch • Kicking - Punt kick to moving target - Long kick pass - Scoring from angles - Assisted chip lift - Penalty kick • Travelling - Swerve - Change of pace with the ball • Tackle - Near hand tackle - Delay opponent & shadowing - Frontal tackle - Dive block - Hand off		• Gameplays - How to use a sweeper - How to deal with a sweeper - Man marking - Zone marking • Kicking - Kicking for possession/diagonal ball - Kicking for scores - Cutting in to score - Free kicks/penalties • Ball Retention - Supporting the ball player - Breaking the tackle - Getting out of traffic - Change the direction of play • Tackle - Near hand tackle - Group tackling - Frontal tackle - Checking - Blocking ball	
RESPECT TEAMWORK COMMITMENT ENJOYMENT PRIDE							
ST PATS DONABATE – OUR CLUB. OUR COMMUNITY. OUR FUTURE							



ST PAT'S DONABATE CAMOGIE SKILLS CHART



HOW TO COACH A SKILL?

T - Tell

E - Explain

A - Act

C - Coach

H - Help

DEVELOPING PLAYERS • BUILDING CONFIDENCE • PLAYING TOGETHER • ACHIEVING SUCCESS

6-8 YEARS GET A GRIP	9-11 YEARS CLASH OF THE ASH	12-14 YEARS GET HOOKED	15-17 YEARS SOLO TO SUCCESS	17+ YEARS STRIKE FOR GLORY
TECHNICAL SKILLS REQUIRED - Develop fundamental movement skills – run, jump, throw, catch, strike and kick appropriate to levels of development - Develop passing technique appropriate to level of development - Identify dominant hand - Identify Lock Grip/position - Identify Ready Grip/position - Identify Lift Grip/position - Swing on dominant side using correct technique - Strike on the ground on dominant side - Block on the ground - Tackle on the ground - Clash on ground - Dribble ball along ground - Use correct equipment appropriate to age and level - Use appropriate clothing and footwear - Know the correct body position when executing a skill - Hook a player who is striking ball on ground TACTICAL SKILLS REQUIRED - Adhere to basic rules and ethics - Play Go-Games to learn basic attack and defence skills - Work as part of a team - Listen and follow instructions	TECHNICAL SKILLS REQUIRED - Develop basic skill of: Strike ball on the ground. Demonstrate the skill of striking the ball on the ground in a fluid way - Develop basic skill of: Strike ball on both left and right sides. Demonstrate the skill of striking the ball on both the left and right sides in a fluid way - Develop basic skill of: Lifting slotar while stationary. Demonstrate the skill of lifting the slotar while stationary in a fluid way - Develop basic skill of: Lifting slotar while on the run. Demonstrate the skill of lifting the slotar while on the run in a fluid way - Develop basic skill of: Striking slotar in the air on dominant side. Demonstrate the skill of striking the slotar in the air on dominant side in a fluid way - Develop basic skill of: Catching slotar at chest level. Demonstrate the skill of catching slotar at chest level in a fluid way - Develop basic skill of: Handpassing slotar from the hand. Demonstrate the skill of handpassing slotar from the hand in a fluid way - Develop basic skill of: Hooking. Demonstrate the skill of hooking in a fluid way - Develop basic skill of: Blocking. Demonstrate the skill of blocking in a fluid way - Develop 1st touch control of slotar - Develop the skill of batting down a high ball - Practice technical skills outside of controlled practice – repetitive learning – Against a wall - Practice technical skills outside of controlled practice – repetitive learning – With a friend (1) - Practice technical skills outside of controlled practice – repetitive learning – With a group of friends - Practice technical skills outside of controlled practice – repetitive learning – Everyday TACTICAL SKILLS REQUIRED - Line out in different positions on pitch - Name the different positions on pitch (e.g.) full back - Experience playing in different positions on pitch - Play modified games (e.g.) ground hurling/ lift and strike - Play small-sided games (e.g.) Go Games - Use skills of striking, tackling, lifting in small sided games	TECHNICAL SKILLS REQUIRED - Perform technical skills well from both left and right sides - Demonstrate the skill of lifting slotar on the run in a fluid way - Execute skills at speed - Execute skills in pressure situations (e.g.) while being tackled for possession - Perform the following skill proficiently: Strike slotar in the air - Perform the following skill proficiently: Strike slotar from left and right sides - Perform the following skill proficiently: Strike ball on dominant side in the air while on the run - Perform the following skill proficiently: Handpass off the hurley - Perform the following skill proficiently: Hooking, Blocking, Clashing, Batting - Perform first touch control of slotar in a fluid way - Use skills of striking, tackling, lifting in small sided games with conditioned game rules - Perform the following skills catch slotar overhead, solo ball, Shoot accurately, free taking, sideline cuts - Continue practicing technical skills outside controlled practice session - Individualise skills training to address strengths and weaknesses - Engage in specific target practice TACTICAL SKILLS REQUIRED - Implement key game principles such as running off the ball - Use peripheral vision - Learn to create space - Support players on the ball - Use a game plan - Identify the number worn by the person that plays in a particular position on pitch - Identify and adhere to match rules - Develop decision making: on skill selection - Develop decision making: on positioning - Control and maintain possession of the ball under pressure - Identify the different positional skill requirements - Demonstrate different positional skills - Play practice matches developing positional skills - Play competitive games to apply positional skills - Begin self-analysis in training and competition	TECHNICAL SKILLS REQUIRED - Display confidence in performing Camogie skills including goal keeping skills - Display consistency in performing Camogie skills including goal keeping skills - Display control in performing Camogie skills - Practice skills under competitive conditions - Undertake an intensity of training relevant to competition and opposition - Display individual style of play - Perform the following skill: Flick ball on ground - Perform the following skill: Flick ball in the air TACTICAL SKILLS REQUIRED - Undertake advanced team play when in possession e.g. use of long ball/ diagonal ball - Take sidelines - Adopt a specific role within the team, when taking opposing teams' strengths/weaknesses into account. - Adapt to opponents game plan - Read the game and move on and off the ball accordingly - Adapt game plan to climate wet/wind/ heat - Continue self-analysis in training and competition - Apply decision making in relation to skill selection - Apply decision making in relation to positioning - Implement principles of attack and defence - Undertake competition simulation training - Practice position-specific tactical preparation - Adhere to competitive strategies	TECHNICAL SKILLS REQUIRED - Refine all Camogie skills including goalkeeping skills for - Ensure competition specific training skills are automatic - Improvise skills, if necessary - Undertake high quality technical training - Display control in performances - Display consistency in performances TACTICAL SKILLS REQUIRED - Develop effective competition strategies - Identify team strengths - Identify opposition weaknesses - Adapt strategies to game situations - Practice tactics and strategies in training for matches - Identify importance of organisation in matches - Comply with the team organisation - Identify importance of communication in matches - Communicate effectively to team-mates - Communicate effectively to others, i.e. coach - Use Match analysis techniques - Continue to apply self-analysis in training and competition - Take Penalties

RESPECT

TEAMWORK

COMMITMENT

ENJOYMENT

PRIDE

ST PAT'S DONABATE – OUR CLUB, OUR COMMUNITY, OUR FUTURE



ST PATS DONABATE

LGFA SKILLS CHART



DEVELOPING PLAYERS • BUILDING CONFIDENCE • PLAYING TOGETHER • ACHIEVING SUCCESS



FOOTBALL SKILLS



HOW TO COACH A SKILL?

T - Tell

E - Explain

A - Act

C - Coach

H - Help

NURSERY U6-U8	U-9 to U-11	U-12 to U-14	U-15 to U-18	U-19 to ADULT
Technical • Jumping • Catching - Body • Throwing • Rolling • Bouncing the ball • 4 steps • Pass (hand & fist) • Punt kick • Pick Up • Solo • Shadowing • Encourage both sides • Regular testing of above basic skills	Technical • Catching – High • Soloing – both sides • Pass (hand & fist) – both sides • Punt kick – both sides • Hook kick • Tackle with hand (basic) • Introduction to blocking • Regular testing of above skills	Technical • Developing all skills on both sides: • Hand and fist pass • Punt and hook kick • Soloing • Near hand tackle • Blocking • Evasion skills – side step, roll off • Angles of run • Timing of pass • Importance of getting 'head up' • Regular testing of skills	Technical • Perform multi-functional roles – marking role, target player • Close correction of mistakes; technical and rule based with constructive criticism • Skill development within small sided games • Sports specific skills – free taking, penalties etc. • Regular testing of skills	Technical • Perform multi-functional roles – play maker, decoy, distributor • Reinforcement of skills • Minimise weaknesses in individual game by correction of error using feedback & self-analysis • Consolidate and enhance strengths • Competition specific training
Tactical • FUN games • Fair play • Friendly competition • Spatial awareness • Introduction to team games • Awareness of basic positional roles	Tactical • Basic rules of Go Games • Awareness of opposition • Team play – basic attack and defence • Basic support play • Continued spatial awareness	Tactical • Increased awareness of competition rules • Support play for ball carrier • Identify and address strengths and weaknesses • Appreciation of consequences of actions • Spatial awareness under pressure	Tactical • Full rules of 15-a-side game • Introduction of the 'Sin Bin' • Understand game plans • Implement patterns of play • Develop positional requirements • Basic performance analysis with progression	Tactical • Awareness of oppositions tactical strengths and weaknesses • Use of conditioned games to assist in teaching of tactical moves • Adaptation of different situations i.e. environment, opponents etc. • Implement performance analysis • Ability to adapt tactical strategies during a game • Consideration of tactical developments within a game • Identify opponents game plan and develop counter tactics which are practised

RESPECT | TEAMWORK | COMMITMENT | ENJOYMENT | PRIDE
ST PATS DONABATE – OUR CLUB, OUR COMMUNITY, OUR FUTURE

Additional resources

- [Club Player Competencies Chart - Ladies Gaelic Football](#)
- [Leinster GAA](#)
- [GAA TOBAR Player Pathway - Robert Emmets CLG](#)

3.4 Long Term Athletic Development (LTAD)

- St Pats LTAD training with Paudie Roche - [Lovable App](#)
- LTAD is an approach to coaching that supports children to develop the right skills at the right age and stage.
- The focus is on movement skills, fun, confidence, coordination and enjoyment before early specialisation or winning.
- Players develop at different rates, so sessions should be age-appropriate, inclusive and based on progress rather than pressure.
- Good LTAD helps children stay involved in sport longer, enjoy activity, and reach their full potential over time.

LTAD - Suggested sessions

Session A — Movement Prep / Acceleration / Stability (15 mins)

1. Jog out & Back × 10m × 3 reps
2. Rotation Hamstring Stretch 2 × 10 reps each side
3. Forward Lunge 3 × 8 reps each side
4. Pogos × 10 reps × 2 reps
5. Straight Leg Shuffle × 10m (Jog back) × 2 reps
6. 2 Point Start to 10m (Jog back) × 2 reps
7. Countermovement Jump (CMJ) 3 × 3 reps
8. 80% Acceleration × 10m (Walk back) × 2 reps
9. Rotation Hamstring Stretch 2 × 10 reps each side
10. Side Start — 80% Acceleration × 10m (Walk back) × 2 reps
11. 90% Acceleration × 10m
12. 100% Acceleration × 10–15m

Session B — Movement Prep / Footwork & Agility / Stability (15 mins)

1. Jog out & Back × 10m × 3 reps
2. Rotation Hamstring Stretch 2 × 10 reps each side
3. Forward & Reverse Lunge 3 × 3 reps each side in each direction
4. Pogos × 10 reps × 2 reps
5. Straight Leg Shuffle × 10m (Jog back) × 2 reps
6. 4 Cone Footwork Drill into 10m Run (Jog back) × 2 reps
7. Forward Bound (stick the landing) × 4 reps each leg up to 10m × 2 reps
8. 4 Cone Footwork Drill into 10m Acceleration 80% (Jog back) × 2 reps
9. Lateral Lunge × 6–8 reps each side
10. Forward Bound repeated 4 reps each leg up to 10m × 2 reps
11. 4 Cone Footwork Drill into 10m Acceleration (Jog back) × 2 reps
12. 4 Cone Footwork Drill into 10m Acceleration (Jog back) × 2 reps

N.B: For Exercises 11 & 12, pair the players up — each determines what cone they go to (1,2,3,4) and their partner must mirror them. Let them race.

Excellent resources available on GAA website :

- <https://learning.gaa.ie/GAA15>
- [GAA-15-Warm-Up_Handout_0.pdf](#)

3.5 Healthy Eating, Hydration & Player Nutrition

Good nutrition and hydration help players train, recover, concentrate and enjoy their games. While every family will have different routines and preferences, the club encourages simple, healthy habits that support participation, wellbeing and long-term enjoyment of sport.

This guidance is based on Healthy Eating for Sport resources produced in partnership with the GAA, LGFA, Camogie Association and Safefood.

Before Training or Matches

Players should ideally eat 2-3 hours before activity where possible. Some children may prefer lighter meals, snacks or liquid foods before games or training.

Examples include Sandwiches or wraps / Pasta, rice or potatoes with protein / Toast with toppings / Yoghurt, fruit or smoothies / Bagels, oat-based snacks or cereal

Hydration

Players should bring their own labelled water bottle to all sessions and matches.

Mentors and parents should encourage players to drink regularly throughout the day and not wait until they feel thirsty. Water and milk are the preferred drinks for young players.

Energy drinks are not suitable for children and should not be brought to juvenile activities.

A simple guide for hydration - Pale yellow urine generally indicates good hydration / Darker urine can indicate dehydration and the need for more fluids

Snacks & Match Bags

Players should bring:

- A labelled water bottle
- A small healthy snack if appropriate
- Any required medical items

Suitable snacks may include:

- Fruit
- Crackers or oat cakes
- Nuts and seeds (where appropriate)
- Yoghurt drinks
- Cheese snacks or cereal bars

Recovery After Activity

After training or matches, players should eat and drink to help recovery and prepare for their next session.

Simple recovery foods can include:

- Sandwiches or wraps
- Milk and fruit
- Yoghurt drinks
- Bagels or toast
- Fruit and cheese combinations

Club Environment & Coaching Approach

Mentors are encouraged to help create a positive and healthy sporting environment by:

- Promoting water as the main drink
- Encouraging healthy snack choices
- Avoiding the use of sweets or treats as rewards where possible
- Supporting positive habits around nutrition and hydration
- Leading by example during training and matchdays

Additional Resources

Parents, players and mentors are encouraged to explore the excellent free resources available through the GAA's Tobar learning platform, including guides, posters and practical healthy eating advice for young players.

[Fuel Your Game - Healthy Eating for Sport](#)

The resource includes:

- Parent and coach guides
- Hydration advice
- Healthy snack and recovery ideas
- Matchday nutrition guidance
- Posters and club resources
- Practical wellbeing supports for juvenile players

SECTION 4

PLAYING GAMES



4.1 Juvenile Games Structures & Regulations

Juvenile games operate under different structures depending on the code and age group. Mentors should familiarise themselves with the competition regulations relevant to their teams and should never assume that football, hurling, camogie and LGFA rules are identical.

- Boys' football and hurling are organised through the relevant Dublin GAA structures.
- Girls' football and camogie operate under separate county board structures and regulations.
- The live County Board regulations always take precedence over handbook summaries if rules change during the season.
- The club handbook is intended to explain club practice clearly but does not replace official County Board regulations.

Boys' juvenile games are organised by the Dublin County Board of the GAA and are divided into two sections:

- CCC1: U8-U12 Boys' Football & Hurling
- CCC2: U13-U16 Boys' Football & Hurling

Competition rules, Go Games regulations, league structures and championship regulations are available in the downloads/extras section of [Dublin GAA](#).

Mentors and coaches should review these regulations at the beginning of every season, as rules and competition formats may change annually. The website also contains useful contact information for clubs and referees.

County Board Communication

The Dublin County Board issues regular bulletins throughout the season containing:

- Fixture schedules
- Competition updates
- Regulation changes
- General notices

These bulletins are sent to the Club Juvenile Secretary, who forwards them to Lead Mentors for circulation within coaching groups.

Girls' Football & Camogie Structures

Girls' games are administered separately through:

- [Home - Ladies Gaelic Football](#)
- [Dublin Camogie](#)

Key information including fixtures, regulations and competition updates is available on these websites.

- Camogie fixtures are generally scheduled several weeks in advance and are typically published from January/February onwards.
- Ladies Football fixtures are updated during the season and are available under the Fixtures/Results sections of the relevant websites.
- Teams should nominate two Lead Mentors to receive fixture communication from the club LGFA secretary.
- Under the LGFA regulations, The LGFA secretary must submit a request for approval to the LGFA a minimum of 48 hours in advance - The request should include:
 - Name of the host club
 - Name(s) of the visiting club(s)
 - Location of the challenge match or blitz
 - Date and time of the event
 - Number of teams participating
 - Duration of the event
 - Formal approval will then be issued by the LGFA.
 - This process is primarily in place for insurance and player welfare purposes.
 - The application should be completed by the home club hosting the challenge match or blitz.
 - Requests should be submitted to the LGFA Secretary of the host club at:
stpatricksdonabate.dublin@lgfa.ie

Matchday & Fixture Responsibilities

Mentors are expected to:

- Confirm fixtures with opponents early in the week
- Check venue, throw-in time and pitch allocation
- Confirm referee arrangements where required
- Request approval from LGFA at least 48 hours prior to event
- Notify the club immediately if there are concerns regarding:
 - Inability To Field
 - Fixture Clashes
 - Postponements
 - Venue Issues
 - Cancellations

Where issues arise, the relevant Club Fixtures Coordinator, County Board contact, referee and Referee Coordinator should be informed as early as possible.

Scheduled games are allocated to club pitches by the Club Fixtures Coordinator. Annual and weekly fixture information can be accessed through:

- [Dublin GAA](#)
- [Home - Ladies Gaelic Football](#)
- [Dublin Camogie](#)

Mentor Identification

County Boards now require mentors to wear bibs on matchdays so referees can clearly identify authorised team officials.

- A maximum of four mentors may wear bibs during games.
- Failure to comply may result in fines imposed by the relevant County Board.
- Any fines incurred may be deducted from team funds.

4.2 Playing Games Overview / Rules of play

Link to Go Games Guidebook - [w602r6gkg4ekh3nmqg0h.pdf](#)

Football / LGFA Football Go Games Rules 2026

Overview

These guidelines are based on the latest 2025 Go Games recommendations and are designed to support participation, skill development, enjoyment and equal game time for all players.

Age	Team Size	Pitch Size	Duration	Tackling	Key Rule
U7	4v4-7v7	45m x 30m	10 min blocks up to 40 mins	1 v 1 tackling only	Carry with bounce for 8 steps / 8 sec
U8	5v5-8v8	65m x 40m	10 min blocks up to 50 mins	Standard tackling	1 hop & 1 solo
U9	5v5-9v9	65m x 40m	10 min blocks up to 50 mins	Standard tackling	1 hop & 1 solo
U10	6v6-10v10	100m x 45m	2 x 10 mins x 3 games	Standard tackling	1 hop & 1 solo
U11	6v6-11v11	100m x 45m	20 min blocks up to 60 mins	Standard tackling	1 hop & 1 solo
U12	8v8-13v13	105m x 50m	20 min blocks up to 60 mins	Standard tackling	2 touches permitted

Tackling Guidance

- U7 games are strictly 1 v 1 tackling only.
- U8-U12 use standard association tackling rules.
- Coaches should prioritise safe contact and player confidence.

Important Go Games Principles

- Equal game time for all players
- No published scores, finals or knockout competitions at U7-U11
- Rotate positions to support player development
- Focus on fun, inclusion and skill development

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Hurling /Camogie Go Game Rules 2026

Overview

These guidelines are based on the latest 2025 Go Games recommendations and are designed to support participation, skill development, enjoyment and equal game time for all players.

Age	Team Size	Pitch Size	Duration	Tackling	Key Rule
U7	4v4-7v7	45m x 30m	10 min blocks up to 40 mins	1 v 1 tackling only	No deliberate kicking of sliotar
U8	5v5-8v8	65m x 40m	10 min blocks up to 50 mins	Standard tackling	1 touch on hurley permitted
U9	5v5-9v9	65m x 40m	10 min blocks up to 50 mins	Standard tackling	1 touch on hurley permitted
U10	6v6-10v10	100m x 45m	2 x 10 mins x 3 games	Standard tackling	Standard rules with modifications
U11	6v6-11v11	100m x 45m	20 min blocks up to 60 mins	Standard tackling	Standard rules with modifications
U12	8v8-13v13	105m x 50m	20 min blocks up to 60 mins	Standard tackling	1 touch on hurley permitted

Tackling Guidance

- U7 games are strictly 1 v 1 tackling only.
- Players may crowd on a loose sliotar at U7.
- U8-U12 use standard association tackling rules.
- Proper tackling technique and safety should always be emphasised.

Important Go Games Principles

- Equal game time for all players
- No published scores, finals or knockout competitions at U7-U11
- Rotate positions to support player development
- Focus on fun, inclusion and skill development

Naomh Pádraig Donabate Juvenile Games

CC1 Regulations 2026

[Dublin GAA Resources | Reports, Forms & Regulations](#)

[ccc1 regulations for 2025.pdf](#)

Area	Key Points
Go Games Rules	All U8-U12 games played under official Go Games Rules No kick out mark, advanced mark or sin bin
Equipment	Mouth guards compulsory Go Games equipment only Correct goalposts and pitch sizes required
Hurling Safety	Metal bands on hurleys must be taped at U12 and below
Team Numbers	Teams must play equal numbers U12 minimum 11, maximum 13 No holding players back if equal numbers available
Fixtures	Mentors must contact opposition by 7pm Friday if unable to field Games are played or conceded
Mentor Bibs	All mentors must wear bibs on sidelines Failure to wear bibs may result in €10 fine
Pitches	If home pitch unplayable, game may switch to away venue
Player Eligibility	Eligibility concerns raised through referee before full-time All players must be registered
Referees	U8-U11: €10 per team U12: €15 per team Home team responsible for organising referee
Respect Initiative	All teams must implement the GAA Respect Initiative
Games	Only CCC1 Chairperson can officially postpone games Communions, confirmations and tournaments are not accepted reasons for postponements
Results	Only U12 results returned No results recorded for U8-U11
League Winners	If U12 teams finish level on points, a playoff must be played
Safeguarding	Garda Vetting valid for 3 years Safeguarding must be renewed every 3 years
St Pats Reminder	Bring bibs • Confirm referee • Follow Go Games rules • Focus on player development and enjoyment

Naomh Pádraig Donabate Juvenile Games

CC2 Regulations Football and Hurling 2026

[ccc2-football-and-hurling-regulations-2026.pdf](#)

[Dublin GAA Resources | Reports, Forms & Regulations](#)

Area	Key Points
Equipment	Football: U13-U15 Size 4 U16 Size 5 Sliotar: U13-U15 Size 4 U16 Size 5
Team Numbers	15-a-side standard Minimum 13 players Some lower leagues may play 11-a-side Unlimited substitutions
Substitutions	Referee must be notified All substitutes entering field must carry a bib Incorrect bib procedure may result in €25 fine
Kick Outs / Puck Outs	U13/U14 football kick outs from hand on 20m line U15/U16 from ground Marks, 45s, puck outs and 65s as per Official Guide
Fixtures & Pitches	Play or concede system If home pitch unplayable, fixture may reverse Communicate cancellations early
Player Eligibility	All players must be registered Eligibility concerns raised before full-time
Panels	Max 24 players Max 3 younger players on match day No movement between Féile/Cup panels
Referees	Home team contacts referee by Wednesday €20 per team If no referee arrives, away team may referee
Team Sheets	Use Foireann team sheets Must include player and mentor registration numbers Hand to referee before game
Sideline Rules	All mentors must wear bibs Positive sideline behaviour expected
Filming	Requires CCC2 permission, parental consent and opposition approval
St Pats Reminder	Bring bibs • Print team sheets • Confirm referee • Respect CCC2 regulations

Naomh Pádraig Donabate Juvenile Games

Regulations LGFA 2026

[Official-Guide-2026.pdf](#)

[Development Guidebook 2026](#)

Area	Key Points
Equipment	Football: Size 4 generally used at underage grades Mouthguards mandatory for all players Correct match ball required for age group
Team Numbers	15-a-side standard Alternative formats may include 13-a-side, 11-a-side, 9-a-side or 7-a-side depending on age and competition
Substitutions	Unlimited substitutions permitted in most underage competitions Referee must be informed before player enters field
Kick Outs	Kick outs taken from the 20m line U13/U14 generally from hand Marks and kick out rules as per Official Guide
Playing Rule Enhancements	Kick-out mark introduced on or beyond 40m arc 3 v 3 structure rule in certain competitions 40m scoring arc for 2-point scores Solo-and-go free kicks allowed Stronger sanctions for delaying play and dissent
Tackling & Contact	Controlled contact permitted in some situations Initial tackle contact must be on the ball Shoulder charges remain illegal
Fixtures & Pitches	Play-or-concede system may apply Fixture reversals possible if pitch unavailable Early communication of cancellations expected
Player Eligibility	All players must be properly registered on Foireann Eligibility objections must be raised before full-time
Panels	Competition regulations may limit panel sizes Younger player movement governed by CCC/LGFA rules
Referees	Home team usually responsible for referee contact Respect for referees and officials expected at all times
Team Sheets	Use official Foireann team sheets Include player and mentor registration numbers Hand to referee before game
Sideline Rules	Positive sideline behaviour expected Mentors should remain within designated areas Respectful communication with officials and players required
Head Injuries	Suspected head injuries must be treated seriously Player welfare always takes priority
Filming & Social Media	Parental consent required Opposition and competition permissions may also be required before filming or streaming

Regulations Camogie 2026

[Part-1-Official-Guide-A4-11-05-26-WEB.pdf](#)

[Part-2-Official-Guide-23-05-25-A4-.pdf](#)

Area	Key Points
Equipment	Mandatory helmet with full facial guard Size 4 sliotar only Hurley bas cannot exceed 13cm except goalkeeper No jewellery permitted
Team Numbers	15-a-side standard Minimum 12 players to start 12-a-side formats permitted in some competitions
Substitutions	5 substitutions in standard games Unlimited substitutions in underage club games Temporary blood and concussion replacements allowed
Player Welfare	Suspected concussion players must leave field immediately Referee can prevent player returning if unfit Player welfare prioritised at all times
Playing Gear	Teams must wear distinctive colours Players may individually choose skort, skirt or shorts Goalkeepers may wear tracksuit bottoms in some competitions
Pitch & Goals	Pitch 130m-145m long and 80m-90m wide Standard 13m, 20m and 45m markings Goalposts 6.5m apart
Synthetic Pitches	Camogie may be played on synthetic surfaces if both teams agree
Team Sheets	Official CC2/Foireann team sheets required Team list must be signed by authorised official Failure may result in fine
Player Eligibility	All players must be registered members of An Cumann Camógaíochta Eligibility governed by official rules and bye-laws
Female Liaison Officer (FLO)	Every management team must include a Female Liaison Officer FLO acts as player liaison and welfare support person
Tackling Rules	Hooking and blocking permitted Minimal side contact only Aggressive or cynical contact prohibited
Scoring	Goal = 3 points Point scored over crossbar Hand-pass may score a point only
Sideline Behaviour	Clubs responsible for conduct of players, mentors and supporters Respect for referees and officials expected
Safeguarding	All units must comply with Child Safeguarding policies and mandatory procedures
One Club Model	Camogie officially supports integrated One Club structures with GAA and LGFA

Naomh Pádraig Donabate Juvenile Games

4.3 Purchase of Equipment / Requisition Process

Equipment should be ordered centrally to ensure spending is controlled, duplication is avoided and club finances are protected. The process is designed to provide fairness, oversight and proper budget management, not to delay teams.

Equipment Ordering Process

1. The Juvenile Chairperson and Vice Secretary will advise Juvenile Lead Mentors when the next equipment order window is open. Orders will generally be placed periodically throughout the season.
2. Teams should submit all equipment requests through the designated club ordering contacts.
3. All requests will be reviewed in line with available club funds and approved through the Treasurer process.
4. Once approved, orders will be placed centrally by the club.
5. When equipment arrives, Lead Mentors will be notified and collection arrangements will be organised.
6. Teams are not permitted to place independent orders directly with suppliers unless expressly authorised by the club.

Standard Team Equipment

Basic training equipment can be ordered through the club equipment process, including:

- Footballs
- Sliotars
- Bibs
- Cones
- First aid kits

The club should also outline what is considered essential stock for each team at the beginning of the season.

Team Fundraising

The club continues to operate under financial pressure, and teams are encouraged to support their own activities through fundraising initiatives where possible.

Suggested fundraising activities may include:

- Table quizzes
- Cake sales
- Supermarket bag packing
- Other approved local initiatives

Bag packing opportunities may become available periodically during the year. Teams should speak with their coordinator regarding available fundraising opportunities.

4.4 Mobile Goals / Goal Safety

- Mobile goals must always be secured correctly when in use. Mentors should use sandbags, heavy rubber weights, clips or other approved anchoring methods to ensure goals are safely tied down and stable at all times.
- For younger age groups, mobile goals are often used to create the appropriate pitch size for games and training activities.
- Mobile goals must always be returned to the designated storage areas after use.
- Mentors must never allow children to climb, swing or hang from goals under any circumstances.
- Goal safety is a non-negotiable duty of care responsibility and must be treated as a priority at all times.
- Slalom poles may be used with younger age groups; however, mentors should exercise caution as the poles can have pointed ends and may present a safety risk if used incorrectly.

4.5 Mouth Guards

- All juvenile players must wear a mouth guard for all football training sessions and matches, without exception, in line with GAA and LGFA regulations.
- Mentors should treat mouth guards as a standard piece of required equipment, the same as boots or a helmet in hurling and camogie.
- Any player without a mouth guard must not take part in football activity.
- Depending on the age grade regulations, players participating in a game without a mouth guard may receive a card from the referee
- Parents and guardians should be reminded of the mouth guard requirement at the beginning of each season and periodically throughout the year.
- The Irish Dental Association recommends custom-fitted mouth guards for pre-teens, teenagers and adults after baby teeth have been replaced. These provide greater protection and are generally more comfortable than standard “boil and bite” mouth guards.

4.6 Kit / Jersey / Uniform / Coaches Bibs

How teams present themselves on match day reflects the standards and values of the club. Mentors should lead by example and ensure players are turned out correctly and respectfully at all times.

- The Lead Coach is responsible for the overall presentation and organisation of the team on match day.
- Only approved club match jerseys (o'neils) should be worn for official games unless otherwise agreed by the club.

CCC1 (U8–U12)

- Official match-day kit should consist of:
- Club jersey
- Club shorts/skorts
- Club socks

CCC2 (U13+)

- Teams should use numbered jerseys for official fixtures.
- The requirements and allocation of numbered jersey sets should be agreed and mapped out centrally.
- Match jerseys from U13 upwards should remain under mentor control where required for games and competitions.

Mentors must also comply with any county board requirements regarding coaches' bibs, sideline identification or official match-day regulations.

4.7 What is streaming

What is Streaming?

Streaming is putting players of similar ability on the same team as opposed to having a team of mixed ability playing together.

Why do we Stream?

The central theme behind Streaming is about developing those players who are not considered as the “strong” players and by putting these players together they will all get a better chance to get more of the ball and consequently have more fun and develop.

How do we Stream?

Streaming is a player centric process and the mentors try and find the right team for the player to play on in order to develop the player’s confidence, skills and participation.

Are there different approaches to Streaming?

Yes. One approach is to simply rank all the players by ability and assign them to teams accordingly. This is a valid approach. Another method is to rank players BUT establish a group of players that are let’s saying marginal A or B players. In this approach these players are not assigned to a specific team and would alternate from week to week at the mentors discretion on either A or B.

For either approach, the norm is that all the mentors for the wider group would meet at the beginning of the year and review each player and agree what approach they will adopt as a mentoring group and also which team best suits the player. A mentor parent of a player is encouraged not to offer a view on their own child.

The team assignment is generally not a scientific process but is rather just the views/opinions of the mentors that are close to that individual child. So it is subjective, but the mentors do strive to do this in a fair and open way and always with the child's interest in mind but also noting that we have to balance playing numbers across team panels.

Is streaming a fixed outcome?

No. It is well recognised that players develop at different times and at different rates. Based on this we encourage the mentoring team to review the players at least twice more during the year; once after Easter and finally after the summer. At those review points it is normal that some players move to a different team. Again this is done with the best interests of the player in mind. Sometimes moving to a lower team is the right decision for a player as they will enjoy more of the ball and more time on the ball and consequently their confidence and skills will develop and thus position them for future growth.

Approaches to Streaming and the wider playing group?

While streaming is an important practice it is also important to ensure that the players do not lose the sense of the wider group as many of the players will move up and down through the streamed teams over the year(s). To keep the Group philosophy intact it is important that the group continues to train together for as long as possible. Further it is encouraged that training is not completely streamed.

Team assignments for mentors?

The vast majority of mentors are parents of players within their year. These parent mentors have an understandable interest in bringing their own child to their match and consequently to be involved in mentoring that team. However as a Mentoring team for the year it is important that they agree who is going to mentor each team. Every team needs a mentor(s) and the Mentors that mentor together need to complement each other.

GAA Helpful article on streaming

[How clubs can use 'streaming' as an effective coaching tool](#)

4.8 St Pats policy on streaming

Club principals on streaming

- The goal is not to sort children into fixed labels
- The aim is to place them in an environment where they can develop, compete appropriately and stay connected to the wider year group.
- It is player-centred, not ego-centred.
- It should improve and challenge ALL levels and improve ball involvement for all players at all abilities
- It is reviewed regularly and should not be treated as fixed for the whole year.
- The wider age group should still feel like one group
- Parents should understand the why before they focus on the label.
- The coaching group should review panels at the start of the season and at agreed points during the year.

Club policy on streaming during training

- Training together helps maintain group identity and makes movement between panels more natural.
- At times training may be broken into smaller groups based on ability, in order to challenge players accordingly
- Players will have equal access to all coaches during each session to ensure all players get equal developmental opportunities

Club policy on streaming during Go Game Matches

- Our club encourages a blended approach to streaming
- Coaching groups are encouraged to assess, review and group players periodically throughout the year - based on their playing ability - for example A/B/C ability
- The composition of teams should never be fixed - There should be regular movement of players across teams accordingly - usually one level of movement up and down.
- No player should have a fixed place on any one team for a full season- every player should be rotated regardless of ability
- Coaches should also rotate amongst teams to ensure all players get access to all coaches during matches

Boys Football and Hurling:

Boys teams' across Dublin begin streaming at age 9 in preparation for graded county board competitions which commence at U12.

In the case of U12 Boys football and hurling teams, grading is based on a series of grading matches at start of U12 season.

Player grading is discussed later in this document.

Camogie / Girls Football:

[Under-12-and-Under-13-Progression-Games-Policy-Final-Draft.pdf](#)

In practice many clubs don't stream, and come to agreement on the match day, (however in 2013, clubs were reminded that they must stream for the end of year blitzes.)

Teams and players are graded at the start of every year in January.

Important note - All Girls 2 teams in both codes should review and submit their panels in January. At the summer break you can change the panels for the Dublin Championship. Panels should also be reviewed in summer prior to autumn recommencement of championship.

4.9 Referees

Referees play a vital role in creating a positive, respectful and enjoyable environment for all juvenile players. The way referees are treated by mentors, players, parents and supporters reflects directly on the culture and values of Naomh Pádraig Donabate.

The Club expects all members to support referees and respect their decisions at all times in line with the principles promoted by the GAA, LGFA and Camogie Association.

For Go games - Lead mentors are encouraged to brief the referee prior to throw. Once game commences - no further communication with the referee should take place - This should be communicated with all mentors - on both sides prior to throw in.

Referee Appointments

- For younger age groups, the Club may provide home referees in line with the relevant code and county regulations.
- For older age groups, referees are generally appointed through County Board structures.
- Mentors should familiarise themselves with the current competition regulations for their code, as referee appointment systems may vary between:
 - GAA CCC1 and CCC2 competitions
 - LGFA competitions
 - Camogie competitions
- Guides can be found here:
 - [ccc1_regulations_for_2025.pdf](#)
 - [ccc2-football-and-hurling-regulations-2026.pdf](#)

Club Referees

- For boys', girls' football and camogie matches up to approximately U10/U12 (depending on code regulations), the Club may allocate home referees.
- Home referees are coordinated within each age group through the Club referee co-ordinators and referee communication groups.
- Young referees should be encouraged, supported and treated with the same respect as adult referees.

Home Team Responsibilities

- The HOME team is responsible for contacting the referee in advance of the fixture to:
 - Confirm availability
 - Confirm venue, throw-in time and pitch details
 - Notify the referee immediately of any changes or cancellations
- Failure to communicate fixture changes properly may result in:
 - Referee fees still being payable
 - Additional unnecessary costs to the Club
 - Damage to the Club's reputation and relationships with referees

Match Day Standards

- Referees must be treated respectfully before, during and after all games.
- Mentors are responsible for setting the tone on the sideline and ensuring players, parents and supporters behave appropriately.
- Abuse, intimidation, sarcasm or persistent questioning of referees is not acceptable under any circumstances.
- **Sideline behaviour should always reflect the Club values of respect, inclusion and sportsmanship.**
- Any concerns regarding refereeing should be raised through the appropriate county or club process and never through confrontation on match day.

Competition Rules

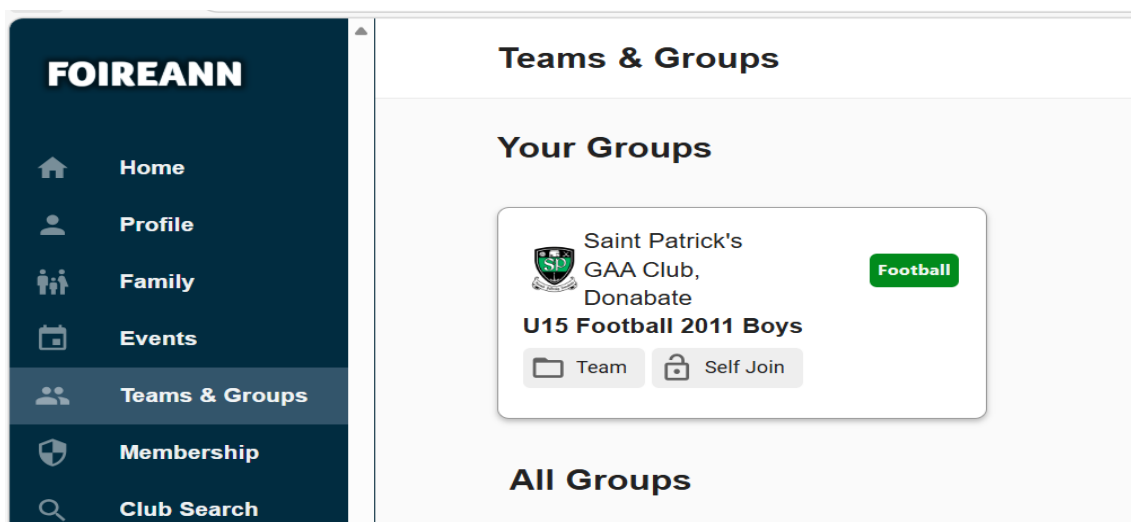
- In CCC2 competitions, if an appointed referee does not attend, the relevant county competition regulations will apply regarding replacement referees or fixture fulfilment.
- Championship matches may require neutral referees in accordance with County Board regulations.
- For LGFA and Camogie fixtures, referee appointment procedures may vary between league and championship competitions and mentors should review current county guidance before the season begins.

Club Culture

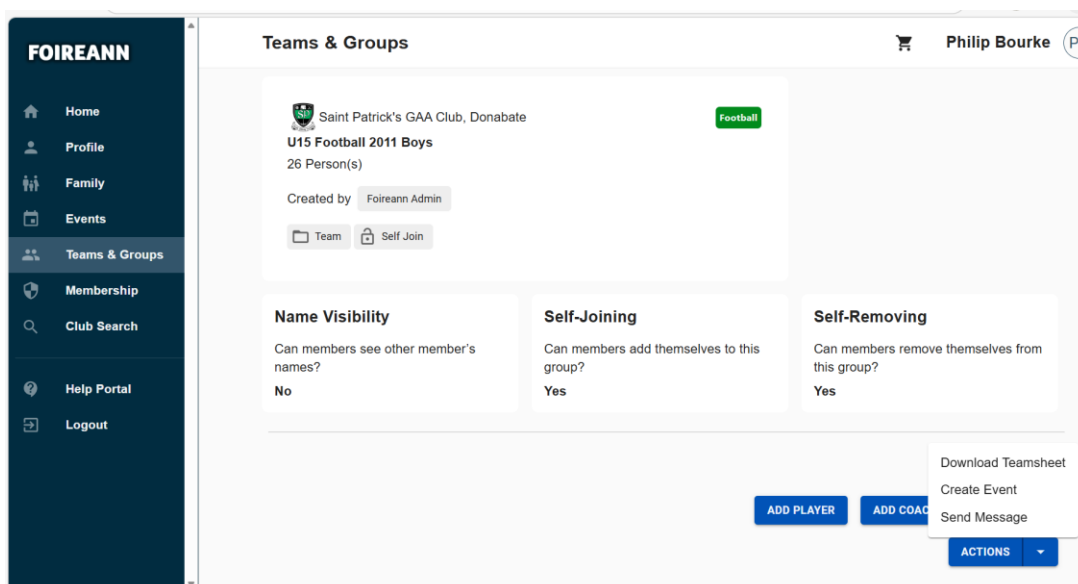
- Referees are essential volunteers and officials within Gaelic Games.
- The standard the Club sets around referee treatment is a visible test of culture and leadership.
- Naomh Pádraig Donabate is committed to creating an environment where referees, including juvenile referees, feel valued, respected and supported.

4.10 Team sheet submissions

- For CCC1 and CCC2 the rules regarding team sheets are listed in the Football and Hurling regulations on the Juvenile download section of the Dublin GAA website.
- Team sheets in CCC1 & CCC2 are downloaded from the Foireann website or app. The Club registrar will assist setting up the team and ensuring all your squads players are included.
- Navigate to the website and select your team when set up.



When the team is selected you can download your team sheet to fill out with player numbers, opposition and date on the date of the match.



CCC1 Team Sheet Rules

- CCC1 does not contain detailed team sheet submission rules like CCC2 does.
- For CCC1 team sheets are not required but any issues with player eligibility need to be directed to Parnell Park via the Club Secretary.
- Note - u8 Camogie teamsheets are required for every second fixture and for every fixture from u9 up - They can be submitted via gogames.dublin@camogie.ie

CCC2 Team Sheet Rules

- Team sheets are mandatory for all CCC2 games
- Clubs must use:
 - The GAA Foireann system
 - Official Foireann team sheet format
- Information required on team sheets must include:
 - Players' names - in Irish and English
 - GAA registration numbers
 - All mentor names
 - Mentor GAA registration numbers
- Duplicate copies required and team sheets must be handed to the referee, before the match, in duplicate. They are not handed to the opposition mentor
- Failure to comply can result in:
 - €10 fine for missing mentor details
 - €10 fine for not submitting team sheets correctly
 - Possible forfeiture of the game
- A substitution slip is needed the first time a player enters the field and must include; full name of player going on and full name of player coming off
- Referee must be notified and approve all substitutions
- All substitutes entering the field must carry a bib - Failure to follow bib rule is a €25 fine

4.11 Return of Match Results

CCC1 Match Result Rules (U8–U12)

U8–U11 Fixtures

- No match results should be submitted for U8, U9, U10, U11 competitions

U12 Fixtures

- Match results for U12 competitions must be submitted by the Home Mentor.
- Results should be emailed to your relevant body; juvresults@dublingaa.ie (gaa/Hurling) or gogames.dublin@camogie.ie (Camoige) / smallsidedgamesdlgfa@gmail.com (LGFA)
- Results must be submitted before 12 noon on the Monday following a weekend fixture or the following day for midweek fixtures
- If the Home Mentor does not submit the result, the opposition club should email the match outcome by Tuesday.
- Clubs failing to return results on time may be subject to a fine.

CCC2 Match Result Rules (U13–U16)

The responsibility for submitting match results rests with the Match Referee. This includes:

- Official CCC2 referees
- Replacement referees
- Home or Away team referee replacements where applicable
- Results must be submitted before 12 noon on the Monday following a weekend fixture or before 12 noon on the following day for midweek fixtures
- A correct and accurate score must always be submitted.
- If CCC2 determines that a false result has been submitted or agreed between teams - the fixture may be declared null and void and additional sanctions may apply

Unplayed Fixtures

- Where a game is not played or postponed, the Home Mentor must email their relevant body - juvresults@dublingaa.ie (gaa/Hurling) or gogames.dublin@camogie.ie (Camoige) / smallsidedgamesdlgfa@gmail.com (LGFA)
- The email should clearly outline the reason the fixture did not take place.

4.12 Challenge matches / Friendly Games

Friendly, challenge /external fixtures should be approved through the appropriate club route so that insurance, notification and safeguarding requirements are met.

- Do not arrange external games casually outside the club process.
- Games outside the usual competition structure should still meet the same supervision and welfare standards as official fixtures.
- For all approved friendlies, the home team remains responsible for clear communication with the opposition and the referee.

For Insurance purposes, matches must be authorised through your coordinator and board delegate who will notify Dublin County Board / Camogie Board / Ladies Dublin County Board. All boards must be given at least 3 days written notice. Do not contact the County Board directly yourself.

4.13 Féile Competitions

John West Féile Peile na nÓg is the official national U15 club festival and competition for Gaelic Football and Ladies Gaelic Football. Féile combines competitive games with participation, club identity, friendship and respect, and is regarded as one of the most important experiences in juvenile Gaelic Games.

Féile competitions are organised at:

- County level
- Regional level
- National level

Division 1 county winners progress to the National Féile competition, while Division 2 and Division 3 winners progress to Regional Féile events.

Eligibility and Panels

- Féile is played at Under 15 level.
- Eligible players must fall within the official Féile age guidelines for that year.
- Teams are generally 15-a-side, although some divisions may operate 13-a-side formats.
- A maximum panel of 26 players is permitted in 15-a-side competitions.
- Players may only play for the panel on which they are officially registered.
- Teams may not be created solely for Féile participation.

The Féile Charter strongly encourages clubs to bring as many eligible players as possible in keeping with the participation ethos of the competition.

Playing Rules

Féile games are played under the official rules of the relevant code, with additional Féile-specific regulations applying - These vary from year to year - below is a guide only - ensure you check each year's rules as issued by county board.

Key Féile rules include:

- Games are generally 12 minutes per half.
- Extra time in knockout games is 5 minutes each way.
- A Size 4 football is used.
- Teams must be ready at the sideline at least 10 minutes before throw-in.

For LGFA Féile competitions:

- A 45m kick taken from the ground that goes directly over the bar scores two points.
- Sin bin timings are reduced due to shorter game durations.

Participation and Substitutions

- A central principle of Féile is that players should have the opportunity to participate and contribute meaningfully.

Official Féile rules require:

- Squads are submitted to the county board in advance of the competition.
- Unlimited substitutions during games.
- Mandatory substitutions at designated times in each half.
- A minimum of four substitutions during normal time.

Failure to comply with substitution rules may result in forfeiture of the match.

At St Pats Donabate, mentors should aim to balance competitiveness with player development and involvement, while remaining consistent with Féile participation rules and the overall ethos of the competition.

Behaviour and Respect

The Féile Charter places a strong emphasis on respect, behaviour and sportsmanship from:

- Players
- Mentors
- Parents/guardians
- Supporters
- Club officials

All teams are expected to support the “Give Respect, Get Respect” initiative.

This includes: Respecting referees and officials at all times, Positive sideline behaviour, Respect towards opponents and teammates, Handshakes before and after games between teams and officials

Abuse, threatening behaviour or misconduct from players, mentors or supporters may result in disciplinary action, elimination from the competition or suspension from future Féile participation.

Mentor Responsibilities

- A maximum of four mentors may be involved with a Féile team on matchdays.
- Girls’ teams must include at least one F.L.O.
- One mentor should have first aid training.

Mentors should ensure that Féile remains a positive and memorable experience for players, with standards of behaviour and player welfare maintained throughout the competition.

****Mentor note**

- Organising a Féile is a large under-taking for each mentor group - it’s highly recommended that you reach out to the year before you for advice and guidance - you will also find a checklist in the appendix section of this handbook to assist you .
- It is strongly suggested that you start your preparations for Féile a minimum of 9 months in advance.

4.14 Fulfilment of Fixtures

Fulfilling fixtures matters because it respects opponents, referees, county boards and your own players. Teams should make every reasonable effort to field once a fixture is confirmed.

- Confirm availability early in the week.
- Escalate likely issues immediately rather than late on match day.
- If a fixture cannot be fulfilled, notify the club and the opposition at the earliest realistic opportunity.
- Chronic late withdrawals damage player trust and club reputation.

Where a game is not played or postponed, the Home Mentor must email their relevant body - juvresults@dublingaa.ie (gaa/Hurling) or gogames.dublin@camogie.ie (Camogie) / smallsidedgamesdlgfa@gmail.com (LGFA)

The email should clearly outline the reason the fixture did not take place.

4.15 Club Policy on Playing Within Age

The club's default position is that players must train and play within their natural age group. This protects development, supports welfare and prevents inconsistency between teams.

The above will be overseen by the Juvenile chairperson and GPO at the academy exit stage.

Playing up may be appropriate in limited circumstances, but it should never become a casual solution that undermines the younger player's own team or displaces older players unfairly.

- Natural age group comes first.
- Parent or guardian consent is required where a player is asked to play up.
- A younger player's own age-group fixture takes priority in the event of a clash.
- The child's welfare, confidence and development must outweigh short-term team convenience.
- Concerns should be raised through the Juvenile Chairperson rather than argued through sideline conversation or informal pressure.

It is impossible to adjudicate in advance of specific games and circumstances. We have attempted to provide guidelines, which mentors should adhere to, and which can be openly explained to players and parents. These guidelines are contained in the Clubs' playing up policy which can be found here [St Pats Juvenile Playing Policy-1Oct2021.pdf - Google Drive](#)

Where there is a disagreement between mentors regarding the temporary release of a player to play up, the matter may first be referred to the Juvenile Chairperson and, if either mentor disagrees with that decision, it may then be appealed to the Executive Committee.

4.16 Competitive Teams

From the point at which an age group has multiple teams and enters graded competition, some teams may operate at a more competitive level than others. That does not mean one group of children matters more than another. It simply means expectations may need to be more clearly defined.

- All teams should aim to be as competitive as possible within the capability of that individual team, but not at the expense of equal development opportunities for all players.
- Parents and players should understand the expectations before the season starts.
- At younger ages, development and broad game involvement remain the priority.
- At older youth stages, commitment, player attitude and the needs of the game may have a greater influence on playing time.

4.17 Grading Principles

What is grading

From U12 Boys and U13 Girls onwards, teams take part in “grading games” to help determine the most suitable league for the upcoming season. This grading process is generally a continuous process from u12 onwards.

The purpose of grading is to place teams in an environment where they can compete appropriately, develop their skills, and continue to enjoy their games.

The aim of grading is not to create “strong” and “weak” teams, nor to win divisions at all costs. The objective is to place players and teams at the level most appropriate for their current stage of development, while protecting long-term player confidence, enjoyment, participation and retention.

St Pats Donabate believes that players represent the club and their wider age group, not just one individual team.

St Pats Donabate Approach to Grading

Grading can be a challenging process, particularly for first-time mentors. The Juvenile Committee will provide support, guidance and practical knowledge to assist mentors through the process.

Lead mentors will be contacted during the June prior to grading commencing the following January, allowing time for planning, discussion and preparation.

To help build consistency and shared learning across the club, mentors involved in grading will also contribute to supporting the age group directly behind them within their code(s). This allows practical experience, knowledge and guidance to be passed on in real time from one group to the next.

The club's aim during grading is to place teams in the most competitive league possible while still ensuring that:

- Games remain competitive and enjoyable
- Players continue to develop with confidence
- Teams are capable of winning approximately 40–60% of their games over the course of a season
- Players experience challenge without becoming discouraged

The overall focus should always remain on long-term player development, enjoyment and retention, alongside creating a positive and competitive environment for all players.

Boys' Grading Guidelines

From U13 onwards, boys' teams are entered into graded league and championship structures through Dublin GAA CCC2.

The club should aim to:

- Enter teams at the most appropriate competitive level.
- Avoid placing teams in divisions where they experience regular heavy defeats or wins.
- Maintain flexibility between panels where CCC rules allow.
- Allow movement of players between teams based on development and performance.
- Ensure movement between panels is visible and positive.
- Review panels regularly during the season.

As a general guideline:

- "A" players normally play at A level only.
- "A/B" players may move between A and B panels.
- "B/C" players may move between B and C panels.
- "C" players may remain at C level until ready to progress.

These groupings are guidelines only and should never become permanent labels.

The club recognises that maintaining competitive lower teams is important for player confidence, enjoyment and long-term retention.

Girls' Grading Guidelines

Girls' teams operate under separate LGFA and Camogie county board regulations, which are often more restrictive than boys' structures.

In many cases:

- Teams are registered earlier in the season.
- Movement between panels may be limited.

Féile, league and championship rules may restrict regrading during the year.

Because of this:

- Greater emphasis must be placed on careful panel review before teams are submitted.
- Parents and players should understand the level of commitment expected at different grades.
- Mentors should continue to review player development even where formal movement is restricted.
- Challenge games and shared training may be used to support player development across panels where appropriate.
- Despite competition restrictions, the club's developmental ethos should remain the same across all girls' teams.

Club Principles on Grading

- Grading should always be player-centred and development-focused.
- Teams should be entered at a level where games are competitive and developmental, without regular one-sided wins or defeats.
- Competitive does not mean winning every match or division.
- Children develop at different athletic, social, physical and skill levels and at different rates.
- Panels and player groupings should be reviewed regularly and should not be viewed as fixed for an entire season.
- Movement between panels should remain possible where competition rules allow.
- Development, attitude, attendance, effort and commitment should all form part of grading and selection decisions, alongside current playing ability.
- Lower graded teams should still receive strong coaching support, encouragement and developmental opportunities.
- The wider year group should continue to train and identify as one overall group where possible.

Panel Reviews

- The coaching group should review panels - at the beginning of the season, before league entries are finalised and at agreed review points during the year
- Following significant changes in player development, attendance or squad numbers
- These reviews should be carried out collectively by the coaching group in the best interests of the full age group.

Flexibility and Player Movement - Where regulations permit:

- Players should have opportunities to move between panels based on development and readiness.
- Movement between teams should be viewed positively as part of player development.
- No player should be labelled permanently based on one grading decision.

Mentors should communicate clearly and respectfully with parents during parent meetings regarding the developmental rationale behind grading decisions, ensuring that all discussions remain aligned with the club's ethos and player-centred approach. **.Club Ethos** - The club's overall objective is to ensure that every player:

- Feels valued within their age group
- Receives appropriate challenge and support
- Has the opportunity to develop and improve
- Enjoys participating in Gaelic Games
- Remains connected to the club long-term
- Grading decisions should always reflect the long-term development of players and teams rather than short-term results.

Additional links:

www.dublinladiesgaelic.ie/content_page/10008056/

http://www.dublincamogie.ie/Camogie_Rules/Default.15357.html

4.18 Guidance on Nominations of Players

The club recognises that intercounty and Player Development Programme (PDP) opportunities can be positive and rewarding experiences for players. These pathways should support long-term player development, enjoyment and wellbeing, while remaining aligned to the values and ethos of Naomh Pádraig Donabate.

Coaches should support players involved in these processes by helping them balance their commitments while maintaining their engagement with the club. As mentors we have a duty of care to safeguard the long term physical and mental wellbeing of these children. They should feel supported by the club in these ventures.

The purpose of this guidance is to support mentors in approaching nominations in a fair, transparent and player-centred manner.

4.18.1 Player Development Programme (PDP) - LGFA /Camogie

The LGFA Player Development Programme (PDP) is a national initiative delivered by Dublin LGFA to support the development of players who show potential, commitment, and enthusiasm for the game. It provides players with access to additional, high-quality coaching and development opportunities outside of their club environment. The programme focuses on enhancing technical skills, game understanding, physical development, and confidence. The PDP typically provides development opportunities for players in underage groups (generally U13/ U15/U17, depending on county structures).

Steps

- The Dublin LGFA will reach out to the secretary of each club to provide club and coaches on the upcoming PDP.
- Information on the number of nominations and processes are decided yearly based on the number of volunteer coaches available and will be shared by email, with a tight deadline provided.

The club's role

- It is essential that all coaches at this age groups are considering nominations from January of the particular year so that informed and considered decisions can be made (as point 4 below highlights).
- Participation in the PDP complements, but does not replace, the player's involvement with their club team.
- To identify and nominate players who may benefit from the programme, based on ability, attitude, effort, and commitment (see point 4 below).
- The club continues to provide an inclusive, positive, and development-focused environment for all players, regardless of PDP selection.
- Coaches play a key role in recognising and encouraging players who may be suitable for nomination.
- Coaches should reinforce that PDP selection is an opportunity for development, not a measure of overall success, and ensure all players feel valued and supported.
- Coaches do have the opportunity to apply to coach the PDP, it acts as an excellent learning curve for coaches as well as players and may (but not guaranteed) provide an option for other girls to attend.

4.18.2 Intercounty Pathways - - LGFA / Camoige

County Board Talent selection process - LGFA

Playing at county level (U14, U16 and Minor) within the LGFA provides players with an opportunity to compete at a higher standard, represent their county and club, and further develop their skills and game understanding. County panels are selected through a trial and scouting process, often informed by club nominations and observations by county coaches. The focus is on identifying players who demonstrate good ability, work ethic, attitude, coachability, and commitment. Participation at county level supports player development by exposing them to higher intensity training, stronger competition, and structured coaching environments. Being involved at county level is a significant commitment and runs alongside, not instead of, club participation.

Steps

1. The Dublin LGFA will reach out to the secretary of each club during the Championship stage (end of September/October) to provide information to the club and coaches on the upcoming trials.
2. Information on the number of nominations and processes are decided yearly, and will be determined by the Division that the club are registered in (eg: Div 1 teams will be able to nominate more players than Division 6).
3. The club's role is to support and nominate players who may be capable of playing at county level, these may not be the same players as you would nominate for PDP (as per point 4 below)
4. The club does not influence final selection decisions, which are made by county management teams.
5. The club continues to support all players equally and promotes an inclusive and positive environment, regardless of county selection.
6. The club also supports players who are successful in making county panels by helping them manage their commitments.
7. Coaches should provide honest guidance to players and parents around the commitment, expectations, and demands of county football.
8. Coaches should support players involved at county level while ensuring they remain connected to and committed to their club.
9. Coaches should also remember that they nominated players to engage in this and should therefore support in all aspects of the journey.
10. Coaches should reinforce that county selection is not the only pathway to success, and all players should feel equally valued.
11. Coaches should continue to focus on player development, enjoyment, and team values, ensuring a positive experience for everyone involved in the club.

4.18.3 County Board Talent selection process - GAA Football & Hurling

- At the start of the year the Dublin GAA Development Officer will contact the club seeking an email address for the lead u14 mentor. When shared the Dublin GAA academy will contact the lead mentor regarding a 7 a side Talent identification blitz.
- Each club can bring a maximum of 10 u14 players (minimum 7). Their birth year MUST be the u14 year of that season (unless you need to bring more junior players to make up 7 players).
- Dublin GAA ask that each player's assessment is based on Skill (the most important factor to determine a young player's suitability), Speed, Intensity, Commitment, Interest in sport and football.
- You will be requested to share your squad list in advance. They need to wear numbered jerseys matching the squad list shared on the day of the blitz.
- Dublin GAA will share the blitz fixtures in advance. It is recommended to give players in your squad equal playing time in as many positions as possible including their preferred position.
- Goal keepers should be included if at the required level.
- After the blitz the club mentors will be asked to submit players they feel who may be up to the academy standard to attend the next phase of TalentID sessions.
- This list can include a player who may have been unavailable for the 1st blitz. Note, not all players the mentor submits may be invited back as Dublin GAA have a limit on the amount of players they can view on each day.
- Expect a short list of players to be invited to the next Talent ID session, likely a mixed 15 v 15 game. Dublin GAA ask that players are not informed they are submitted for the next round until they confirm and share the invited names with the lead mentor.
- After this session, Dublin GAA select the player(s) they want to return to following sessions. This may iterate a few times. The lead mentor will be the point of contact for each stage until the Talent ID sessions complete and you will be informed when it is finished. Dublin GAA may also view players at club games as part of their Talent ID if they so wish.
- This process may run from January to June. As it starts early in the year it would be of benefit for the coaching team to start the process of selecting their strongest players before the season ends the previous season at u13s to be prepared when the time comes.

4.18.4 Selection Structure

Where the club is asked to nominate players for Intercounty Trials or PDP opportunities, a small Selection Group should be used rather than relying on the opinion of a single individual.

The process should include:

- The Lead Mentor and wider coaching team from the relevant age group.
- A neutral Intercounty Selection Committee appointed by the club.
- Attendance by members of the Selection Committee at relevant matches and training sessions in the months preceding nominations.
- Observation of players across different environments, not solely based on one performance or tournament.
- The mentoring team submitting proposed nominations to the Selection Committee for review, discussion, input and guidance before final recommendations are agreed.
- Selection timelines differ depending on the code and may fall in either June or October. To ensure fair and balanced consideration of the full panel:
- Mentors and Selection Committee members should be aware of upcoming nomination deadlines well in advance.
- The observation and vetting process should begin early in the season.
- Consideration should include attitude, consistency, coachability, work rate, readiness and long-term development potential, not simply current performance levels.
- Any conflicts of interest, including where a selector has a close personal connection to a player, should be openly declared as part of the process.

4.18.5 Selection Considerations

Players

- Speed, Intensity, Commitment, Interest in sport and football
- Skill level and game understanding
- Player speed and intensity
- Coachability and willingness to learn and interest in sport
- Attitude, effort and consistency over time
- Readiness for the environment and additional commitment
- Emotional maturity and resilience
- The player's own interest and willingness to participate
- Selections should not be based solely on: isolated performances / physical maturity / one competition / or one stream/team within the age group

Representation Across Teams

- All teams and streams within the age group should be considered fairly.
- The process should reflect the full player pool and not favour one mentor group or team.
- The club recognises that talented players can emerge from all teams and at different stages of development.

Player Welfare - Before recommending a player for additional programmes, mentors should consult with parents on these expectations and commitments - including:

- Current playing and training load
- School and family commitments
- Travel demands
- Injury risk and recovery
- Emotional wellbeing and burnout risk
- Players should continue to prioritise enjoyment, participation and connection to their club team.

4.18.6 Communication

- Communication with players and parents should always be respectful, supportive and clear.
- Mentors should reinforce that Nomination is a development opportunity, not a final judgement, Non-selection does not define a player's long-term potential and players develop and progress at different stages.
- The club encourages mentors to avoid language that labels children too early as either "elite" or "not elite".

4.18.7 Oversight

- Concerns regarding nominations or processes should be raised through the appropriate club structures.
- This guidance should be reviewed periodically by the Juvenile Committee and Coaching structures to ensure it remains aligned with club values and best practice.

4.18.8 Key Principles

- Player welfare and long-term development should always come before short-term success or reputation.
- Nomination should be viewed as an opportunity for development, not as a final judgement on a player's long-term potential.
- Players develop at different rates physically, technically, emotionally and socially.
- All players within the age group should receive fair consideration across all teams and streams.
- Players should never feel pressured into participating in additional programmes or intercounty activity.

SECTION 5

PITCHES AND

FACILITIES



5.1 Ballymastone Facilities Overview



Ballymastone is the central training and match venue for our adult and juvenile teams within Naomh Pádraig Donabate. The facility currently includes three full-sized grass pitches, an all-weather pitch, a ball wall, and gym access. As the grounds are heavily used throughout the week, orderly planning, communication, and mutual respect are essential.

- Pitch access and training allocations are coordinated centrally through the Pitch Allocation / Fixtures Coordinator.
- Teams should only use pitches and time slots officially assigned to them.
- All members, mentors, players, and parents must respect any “Pitch Closed” notices issued by the Facilities Group or Club Executive.
- Goals, equipment, and shared areas should be left safely and respectfully after use.

Location: Address and Eircode below

Saint Patrick's Gaa club
Robbie o'farrell park
Portrane Demesne
Portrane
Co. Dublin
K36 A3E7



5.2 Pitch Equipment

- Lead mentors should be provided with access to certain pitch-side facilities and equipment storage areas as approved by the club.
- Lead mentors should location flags and goals prior to match to ensure pitch prepared for a timely throw in
- Access keys may include the ball wall, dressing rooms and all-weather pitch facilities.
- All keys and access privileges remain club property and should be used responsibly.
- Mobile goals, nets and training equipment must be stored away safely and securely after use.
- Proper storage helps protect equipment from unnecessary damage and supports the Grounds Team in maintaining the pitches.
- Storage containers and equipment areas are shared club resources and should be left tidy and ready for the next group.
- Each age group has an allocated storage section, generally shared between boys' and girls' teams within the same age group.
- Any damage, lost keys, security concerns or ongoing access issues should be reported promptly through the appropriate club contact.

5.3 Fixtures & Pitch Bookings

The Pitch Allocation Team / Fixtures Coordinator has sole responsibility for all official pitch bookings and allocations within Naomh Pádraig Donabate. This ensures fairness across all codes and age groups, helps avoid double bookings, and protects against informal side arrangements.

- All booking requests and fixture enquiries must be sent directly to the Pitch Allocation Team / Fixtures Coordinator - Before organising a challenge match please check pitch availability first .
- Only requests submitted through the official process will be considered.
- Mentors should check the live training schedule and booking updates before requesting fixture changes or additional pitch access. [weekly pitch allocation.xlsx](#)
- Early communication is strongly encouraged. Late requests significantly reduce the likelihood of finding a workable solution.
- An unplayable opposition pitch does not automatically mean St Pats can facilitate a late venue switch.
- Fixture and pitch allocation decisions are made in the context of the whole club and all competing demands, not one team in isolation.
- For challenge games, pitch allocations should alternate between home and away fixtures, in order to help protect and preserve club pitches throughout the season.

Under the LGFA regulations, the following details apply to challenge matches and blitzes: LGFA secretary must submit a request for approval to the LGFA a minimum of 48 hours in advance -The request should include:

- Name of the host club
- Name(s) of the visiting club(s)
- Location of the challenge match or blitz
- Date and time of the event
- Number of teams participating
- Duration of the event
- Formal approval will then be issued by the LGFA.
- This process is primarily in place for insurance and player welfare purposes.
- The application should be completed by the home club hosting the challenge match or blitz.
- Requests should be submitted to the LGFA Secretary of the host club at:

stpatricksdonabate.dublin@lgfa.ie

The Fixtures Committee works on an ongoing basis with the relevant county governing bodies, including:

- Dublin GAA County Board
- Dublin Camogie Board
- Dublin Ladies Football Board

Each body independently schedules its own competitions and fixtures and does not take account of the priorities of the other codes when doing so.

As Ballymastone has a limited number of pitches available across adult and juvenile activity, the club's Fixtures Committee has the final decision regarding the timing, location and allocation of official matches and training sessions.

The Fixtures Committee operates with the full support of the Club Executive in managing the club calendar and pitch usage.

5.4 Training Schedules

Training schedules within Naomh Pádraig Donabate are planned around age profile, daylight availability, facility capacity and the large number of teams sharing Ballymastone each week. As the club has many teams but a limited number of training slots, flexibility and compromise are required across all sections.

[weekly pitch allocation.xlsx - Google Drive](#)

The allocation of training slots is coordinated by the Pitch Allocation Team in consultation with Lead Mentors.

General principles used when allocating training slots include:

- Training slots are generally assigned to age groups rather than individual A, B or C teams.
- Where additional capacity becomes available, some extra allocations may be provided to older competitive teams where appropriate.
- Younger age groups should, where possible, receive earlier evening training slots.
- Each age group should ordinarily receive two training opportunities per week, subject to facility availability and weather conditions.
- Winter allocations aim to balance access between the all-weather pitch, ball wall and grass pitches.
- During winter months, age groups will generally receive one all-weather / ball-wall allocation and one grass allocation where conditions allow.
- Mentors should check the live training schedule before requesting changes or additional access.

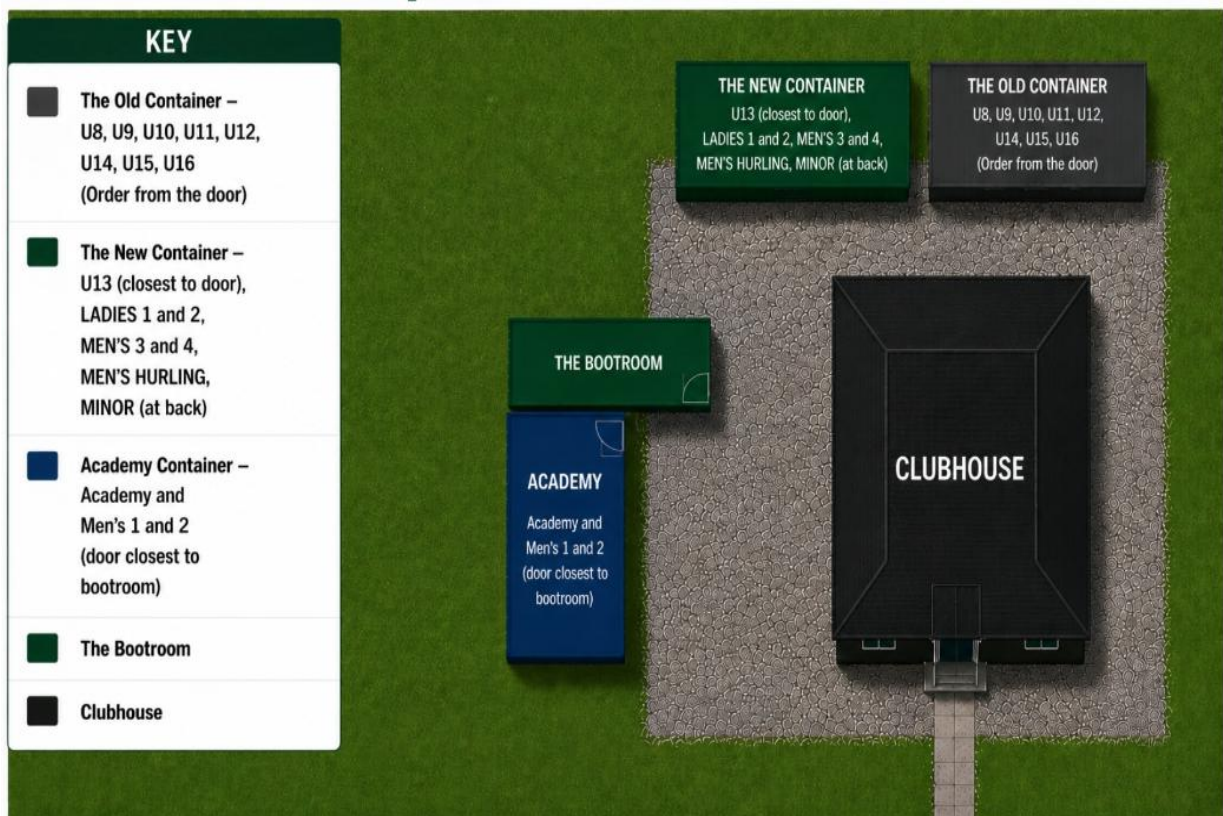
A live training schedule is maintained separately and should always be treated as the most up-to-date reference point for current allocations and changes.

5.5 Storage

Naomh Pádraig Donabate currently has two shared storage containers on site. Each age group has an allocated storage section, generally shared between the boys' and girls' teams of the same age group.

- Storage areas are shared club resources and should be kept organised, safe and usable for all groups.
- Teams should only use their allocated storage section.
- Each age group should move into the storage section assigned to their new age grade each January. The storage sections themselves remain fixed, while teams move sections as they progress through the club age groups.
- Remove broken, damaged or unused equipment regularly.
- Bags, bibs, helmets and specialty equipment should be clearly labelled where possible.
- Shared containers should be left tidy after every session.
- Major storage issues or access problems should be reported through the appropriate club contact rather than creating informal workarounds.
- Equipment should not block walkways, exits or shared access points.

St. Pat's Lock Ups



5.6 Lighting

Pitch lighting is an important club resource and should be used responsibly.

- Only approved personnel should operate pitch lighting systems.
- Users should ensure lights are not left running unnecessarily after sessions or matches.
- If you are the last group using a lit area, you are responsible for ensuring the lights are turned off.
- Any faults or lighting issues should be reported promptly.

The light switches for the all-weather pitch, ball wall and near side of Pitch 1 are located in the clubhouse. Turning right at the Committee Room, the labelled switches are located behind the doors directly ahead. (Pitch 2 instructions can also be found here).

5.7 Lost Property

Lost property should be handled promptly and respectfully to avoid unnecessary build-up within the clubhouse.

- Any lost property should be placed in the designated lost property area in the back left dressing room of the clubhouse.
- Coaching groups should periodically remind parents and players to label helmets, bottles, tops, jackets and personal gear.
- Team communication channels such as ClubZap should be used to notify parents of missing or recovered items.
- Unclaimed items will periodically be cleared out where storage capacity becomes an issue.
- Mentors should encourage all parents to label all juvenile players belongings

5.8 All-Weather Pitch & Ball Wall

The all-weather pitch and ball wall are high-value club facilities and should be treated with care at all times.

- Allocations for the all-weather pitch and ball wall are managed through the Pitch Allocation Team.
- Only moulded studs are permitted on these surfaces in order to protect and maintain the playing area (Please refer to pitch signage for appropriate footwear)
- Goals and heavy equipment should not be dragged across the surface.
- Booked times should be respected and areas left ready for the next group.
- Standard player welfare and supervision rules apply on these surfaces as they do on grass pitches, including the use of helmets and mouthguards where required.
- During Go Games activities on the all-weather pitch, adults who are not official mentors for either team should remain outside the playing enclosure.

All members are asked to help protect these facilities to ensure they remain available and safe for long-term club use.

SECTION 6

APPENDICES



6.1 Useful Links & Online Resources

Club Resources & Communication

[St Pats Donabate Website](#)

The club's main website containing membership information, fixtures, club news, policies, downloads and important updates.

[weekly pitch allocation.xlsx - Google Sheets](#)

Club pitch allocation sheet

[Club Child Protection Section](#)

Contains safeguarding guidance, Code of Behaviour documents, Garda Vetting information and child welfare resources.

[Club Injury Procedure & Physio Policy](#)

Guidance on injury reporting, injury fund claims and physio procedures.

[ClubZap](#)

Official communication platform used by St Pats teams for fixtures, training updates, attendance tracking and parent communication.

[St Pats Donabate on X \(Twitter\)](#)

Official club account for news, fixtures, match results and announcements.

[St Pats Donabate Instagram](#)

Club photos, events, community updates and team achievements.

[St Pats Donabate Facebook](#)

Club community updates, events and announcements.

Coaching, Games Development & Education

[GAA Official Website](#)

Official GAA website containing rules, governance information, fixtures, coaching resources and national updates.

[Dublin GAA](#)

County Board regulations, CCC information, fixtures, forms and coaching updates.

[Dublin GAA Games Development](#)

Games development resources, coaching supports, workshops and skill development materials.

[Tobar – GAA Learning Portal](#)

Official online learning platform for coaching courses, safeguarding certification and development resources.

[Tobar Registration Page](#)

Registration portal for coaches completing safeguarding and coach education courses.

[Introduction to Coaching Gaelic Games \(ICGG\)](#)

Entry-level coaching course and minimum recommended qualification for juvenile mentors.

[Award 1 Coach Education Pathway](#)

Coach education programme for mentors working primarily with juvenile players.

[Award 2 Coach Education Pathway](#)

Advanced coaching qualification for experienced coaches progressing through the coaching pathway.

[Leinster GAA Coaching Resources](#)

Templates, coaching supports and player development resources.

Football, Hurling, Camogie & LGFA

[Dublin Ladies Gaelic Football](#)

Fixtures, regulations, competition information and coaching supports for girls' football.

[LGFA Official Website](#)

[Official-Guide-2026.pdf](#)

[Development Guidebook 2026](#)

National LGFA resources, coaching information and player welfare guidance.

[Camogie Association](#)

Official camogie regulations, coaching resources and development information.

[Dublin Camogie](#)

County camogie fixtures, regulations and club resources.

Foireann & Administration

[Foireann](#) - The GAA's official administration system used for:

- Membership registration
 - Garda Vetting
 - Safeguarding records
 - Coaching qualifications
 - Team sheets and registrations
-

Player Development & Performance

[Player Passport / Youth Athletic Development Platform](#)

Player assessment and tracking platform used for pathway development, movement screening and skills challenges.

[Lovable App](#)

Long Term Athletic development - St Pats with Paudie recap

[GAA15 Warm-Up Programme](#)

Evidence-based injury prevention and warm-up programme for Gaelic Games.

[Fuel Your Game Resources](#)

Healthy eating, hydration and nutrition resources for players, parents and mentors.

Safeguarding & Child Welfare

[GAA Social Media Guidelines](#)

Official guidance on safe and appropriate social media use within Gaelic Games.

[Child Safeguarding Information \(St Pats\)](#)

Club safeguarding information, reporting procedures and child welfare contacts.

Competition Regulations & Fixtures

[Dublin GAA Regulations & Downloads](#)

Access to CCC1 and CCC2 regulations, forms, fixtures and official competition rules.

[Dublin Ladies Football Fixtures & Results](#)

Fixtures, league tables and competition information for girls' football.

[Dublin Camogie Fixtures & Regulations](#)

Fixture schedules, regulations and county competition information.

First Aid & Emergency Resources

[Fingal County Council Sports Office](#)

Sports development supports, club training opportunities and First Aid workshop information.

Internal Team Contact Documents

(Change annually. Available on the download section of the Juvenile section of the Dublin GAA website)

[Juvenile Hurling Contacts 2026](#)

Current mentor and contact information for juvenile hurling teams.

[Juvenile Football Contacts 2026](#)

Current mentor and contact information for juvenile football teams.

[lgfa-club-mentor-contact-list-as-per-17th-march-2026.pdf](#)

Current mentor and contact information for juvenile LGFA and Camogie teams.

Recommended Mentor Bookmark List

If mentors only save a handful of resources, the following are the most useful throughout the season:

1. [St Pats Donabate Website](#)
2. [Foireann](#)
3. [Tobar Learning Portal](#)
4. [Dublin GAA](#)
5. [Dublin Ladies Gaelic Football](#)
6. [Dublin Camogie](#)
7. [ClubZap](#)
8. [Pitch allocation link](#)

6.2 Mentors Checklists

The best coaching groups are organised, consistent and positive.

These checklists are intended to help mentors stay prepared, reduce stress and create the best possible experience for players.

1. Mandatory Mentor Compliance Checklist

Before any mentor is active with a team:

Safeguarding & Compliance

- Garda Vetting completed and in date
- Safeguarding course completed and in date
- Registered on Foireann
- Paid-up club member
- Completed ICGG / Foundation Course
- Mentor ratified by Club Executive
- Contact details supplied to Lead Mentor / Registrar
- Agreed to Club Code of Behaviour
- Aware of Child Protection procedures
- Knows Children's Officer and DLO contact details

Recommended Qualifications

- First Aid / CPR qualified
 - Attended coaching workshop or CPD session
 - Familiar with Go Games / CCC regulations
 - Familiar with streaming and player pathway policy
 - Ideally completion of Level 1 and progressing to level 2 when relevant
-

2. Pre-Season Planning Checklist

Team Setup

- Confirm expected player numbers
- Confirm mentor group and role split
- Confirm communication channels
- Set up ClubZap / Teamer groups
- Confirm emergency contact access
- Confirm medical information process
- Agree coaching philosophy and season goals
- Review player pathway expectations for age group
- Review LTAD focus for the age

Parent Communication

- Schedule annual parent meeting
- Prepare parent agenda
- Communicate attendance expectations
- Explain team structures and streaming approach
- Explain communication process
- Discuss sideline behaviour expectations
- Explain safeguarding and welfare supports
- Ask parents about medical / behavioural considerations
- Seek volunteers for support roles

Administration

- Confirm all players registered
 - Confirm mentors ratified
 - Review competition rules for age group
 - Review CCC / LGFA / Camogie regulations
 - Confirm training slots and pitch access
 - Confirm equipment stock
 - Confirm jersey availability
 - Confirm access to first aid kit and AED
 - Create season calendar
-

3. Start-of-Season Coaching Checklist

Coaching Preparation

- Create seasonal coaching plan
- Create first 6-week block plan
- Identify key skills for this age group
- Agree coaching language and standards
- Plan football and hurling/camogie balance
- Build session templates
- Plan player assessments/challenges
- Schedule player pathway reviews

Team Culture

- Establish team rules and standards
- Promote enjoyment and participation
- Reinforce respect for referees and opponents
- Encourage player confidence and decision making
- Ensure all players feel included
- Create positive sideline environment

Equipment

- Footballs inflated
 - Sliotars available
 - Bibs and cones counted
 - First aid kit stocked
 - Ice packs available
 - Mobile goals checked and secured
 - Coaches bibs available
 - Mouthguard reminders sent
-

4. Term / Block Planning Checklist

(Recommended every 6-8 weeks)

Coaching Review

- Are players improving technically?
- Are sessions age appropriate?
- Are all players actively involved?
- Are stronger players challenged?
- Are less confident players supported?
- Is there enough game-based learning?
- Are players enjoying training?

Player Development

- Review player pathway assessments
- Review skill challenge progress
- Identify players needing support
- Identify players needing greater challenge
- Review movement between groups/panels
- Revisit LTAD priorities

Team Organisation

- Review attendance levels
 - Review mentor workload
 - Refresh session plans
 - Update parent communication
 - Plan blitzes / challenge games / social events
 - Review equipment needs
-

5. Weekly Coaching Session Checklist

Before Training

- What is tonight's objective?
- What are the 1-2 key coaching points?
- Is the session age appropriate?
- What will players do in the first 5 minutes?
- How will we maximise touches?
- How will we minimise standing?
- Is the session game-based?
- Have we planned transitions between activities?
- Is equipment ready before players arrive?

During Training

- Are players active more than listening?
- Are coaches demonstrating clearly?
- Are players solving problems themselves?
- Is feedback positive and specific?
- Are all players engaged?
- Are we adapting if something isn't working?
- Is effort and attitude being praised?

End of Session

- Did we finish positively?
 - Did players leave smiling and engaged?
 - Was the session tempo good?
 - What worked well?
 - What should change next time?
 - Any injuries or incidents recorded?
 - Any follow-up communication needed?
-

6. Matchday Preparation Checklist

Before the Match

- Confirm fixture with opposition
- Confirm pitch and throw-in time
- Confirm referee
- Confirm team numbers
- Confirm jersey allocation
- Confirm mentor bibs
- Print / complete team sheets if required
- Confirm first aid kit available

- Check players have:
 - Mouthguards
 - Helmets (where applicable)
 - Water bottles
 - Correct kit

Team Management

- Arrive early
- Set up goals/cones / flags safely
- Welcome referee respectfully
- Reinforce positive sideline behaviour
- Keep messages simple and calm
- Rotate players fairly where applicable
- Encourage effort and decision making
- Focus on development over winning

After the Match

- Thank referee
 - Thank opposition
 - Return equipment
 - Record result if required
 - Submit team sheet if required
 - Communicate injuries/issues
 - Review positives with players
 - Follow up with parents if necessary
-

7. Referee & Fixture Checklist

Weekly Fixture Process

- Confirm fixture early in week
- Contact opposition
- Confirm venue
- Confirm throw-in time
- Confirm referee arrangements
- Notify referee of any changes
- Notify club if unable to field
- Check weather/pitch updates

Matchday

- Referee welcomed on arrival
 - Referee fee prepared
 - Respect initiative followed
 - Mentors wearing bibs
 - Sideline behaviour managed
-

8. Safeguarding & Welfare Checklist

Player Welfare

- Know medical concerns/allergies
- Know emergency contacts
- Supervision ratios appropriate
- No child left alone after sessions
- Communication through approved channels only
- No one-to-one private messaging
- Positive environment maintained
- Any welfare concerns reported appropriately

Injury & Concussion

- Concussion policy followed
 - "If in doubt, sit them out"
 - Head injuries monitored
 - Accident logged where required
 - Emergency process understood by mentors
-

9. Equipment & Facilities Checklist

Training Equipment

- Footballs / sliotars counted
- Bibs available
- Cones available
- Pumps available
- First aid kit stocked
- Ice packs available
- Water access available

Facilities

- Goals secured safely
 - Goals returned after use
 - Equipment stored correctly
 - Dressing rooms respected
 - Lights turned off if applicable
 - Area left clean after use
-

10. End-of-Season Checklist

Coaching Review

- Review season goals
- Review player development
- Review attendance trends
- Review streaming/panel decisions
- Gather mentor feedback
- Gather parent feedback where appropriate

Administration

- Return jerseys/equipment
- Update player pathway data
- Review mentor compliance for next year
- Identify coach education needs
- Begin planning for next season

Team Culture

- Celebrate player effort and improvement
- Recognise volunteers
- Support transition to next age group
- Encourage player retention
- Finish season positively and inclusively

6.3 Appendices

- Appendix 1: 2026 LGFA PDP - Player Development Programme Information
- Appendix 2: Camogie Official Guide 2026-27 Part 1
- Appendix 3: Camogie Official Guide 2026-27 Part 2
- Appendix 4: CCC1 Regulations for 2025
- Appendix 5: CCC2 Football & Hurling Regulations for 2025
- Appendix 6: Child Safeguarding Statement
- Appendix 7: Club Gear Sample Order Form - May 2026
- Appendix 8: Coaches & Mentors Checklists
- Appendix 9: Dublin Go Games Guidelines Overview
- Appendix 10: Féile Rules 2025
- Appendix 11: Féile checklist for mentors
- Appendix 12: GAA Code of Best Practice in Youth Sport
- Appendix 13: Go Games Guidelines 2025
- Appendix 14: Go Games Playing Rules Overview
- Appendix 15: Go Games Activities Guidebook
- Appendix 16: Guide for Coaches - Healthy Eating for Sport
- Appendix 17: Guide for Parents - Healthy Eating for Sport
- Appendix 18: John West Féile na nGael / Féile Peil na nÓg Charter 2025
- Appendix 19: LGFA Official Guide 2026
- Appendix 20: LGFA Development Guidebook 2026
- Appendix 21: LGFA Playing Rules 2025
- Appendix 22: LGFA Playing Rules Enhancements Summary
- Appendix 23: LTAD Cheat Sheet
- Appendix 24: Nursery Resource
- Appendix 25: Pats Logo Plain
- Appendix 26: Sample Annual Calendar and Key Dates
- Appendix 27: Sample Annual Plan - Overview
- Appendix 28: Sample Session Breakdown Template
- Appendix 29: Sample Session Planner
- Appendix 30: Sample Six-Week Development Block
- Appendix 31: Session Planner Guideline with Durations
- Appendix 32: St Pats - Sample Session Planner (Editable)
- Appendix 33: St Pats Donabate Football Workshop - Coaching Core Skills
- Appendix 34: St Pats GAA Juvenile Playing Policy - Age
- Appendix 35: St Pats Nursery Programme Mentor Summary for Juvenile Handbook
- Appendix 36: St Pats Player Skills Chart - Football and Hurling
- Appendix 37: St Pats Skills Chart - Camogie
- Appendix 38: St Pats Skills Chart - LGFA
- Appendix 39: Team Parent Meeting Template